

CONTINENTAL SHOWPIECE

Aichi-Nagoya Games off to a dazzling start

The 20th edition will see India aim to better the record tally of 107 medals it won in Hangzhou three years ago

SPORT » PAGE 21

Cong. bypoll candidate sent to judicial custody

NEWS » PAGE 14

Will U.S. Sanctioning Act affect India?

FAQ » PAGE 18

U.S., Denmark reach deal on Greenland

WORLD » PAGE 20

NEARBY

'Bypolls being held due to death of democracy'

CHENNAI
DMK leader M.K. Stalin said on Saturday that Tamil Nadu is witnessing byelections in two Assembly constituencies because of the "death of democracy". » PAGE 8

DMK functionary, 5 others booked for 'land fraud'

TIRUCHI
A DMK functionary and five others have been booked in connection with an alleged case of cheating and land fraud in Srirangam. » PAGE 8

CLASSIFIEDS » PAGES 10, 11 & 12
MAGAZINE » 8 PAGES
DOWN TOWN » 8 PAGES
(TABLOID) (IN SELECT AREAS)

Developing nations wrongly blamed for emissions: Modi

PM says India's per capita carbon emissions are less than the global average; claims the country fulfilled all the commitments made at 2015 Paris climate summit; flags hurdles to nuclear energy

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday said the responsibility for carbon emissions had often been "wrongly placed" on developing countries. He also claimed that India was the only G-20 country to have fulfilled all the commitments it made at the 2015 Paris climate summit, and that it had done so ahead of schedule.

Mr. Modi was speaking at the inauguration of a two-day international conference on "The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics", organised by the National Green Tribunal (NGT) at Vigyan Bhavan. The conference brings together jurists, academics, policymakers, scientists,



Big statement: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Justice of India Surya Kant at the NGT conference in New Delhi. PTI

and experts from 17 countries, along with the United Nations Environment Programme and the Asian Development Bank. The NGT said the aim was to identify gaps in policy-making and implementation, and strengthen cooperation among institutions.

"We all know that often the responsibility for carbon emissions has been wrongly placed on developing countries. Many of my companions from the Global South are present here," Mr. Modi said. "But the historical truth is that even today, India's per capita carbon emissions are less than half the global average," he added.

India's growth
The per capita emissions in developed countries were six times India's, he noted and said solar capacity had grown from about 2 GW in 12 years and that non-fossil capacity had nearly quadrupled.

"Those who give long speeches on the environment – when I advance nuclear energy work, they will stand in the courts to stop it," he added, "A pathway has also been created to bring private players into this sector." The SHANTI Act from December 2025 enables this.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 13

Over 22 lakh Bengal voters filed appeals against exclusion: EC

Krishnadass Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A second affidavit filed by the Election Commission (EC) in the Supreme Court has revealed that over 22 lakh voters purged from the electoral roll during the special intensive revision exercise in West Bengal have filed appeals challenging their exclusion.

The number of voters challenging the deletion of their names from the electoral roll is significant as approximately 27 lakh voters were excluded on the ground of "logical discrepancies".

This would mean that a lion's share of the 27 lakh voters may be contesting their exclusion before 19 Appellate Tribunals constituted on the orders of the Supreme Court over six months ago.

The EC's figure of 22,21,118 appeals by excluded voters is striking,



People waiting to submit their petitions before a Special Tribunal in Bengal. FILE PHOTO

particularly given that judicial officers, actively deployed during the SIR verification phase, have already adjudicated these claims and objections.

This is the first time a break-up of the number of appeals concerning both exclusions and inclusions have been given.

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DELHI CM GETS NOTICE
» PAGE 13

Anna varsity student did not die due to dengue: govt.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The cause of death of an Anna University student at the Kilpauk Medical College Hospital (KMCH) on Friday was scrub typhus and not dengue, the Directorate of Public Health and Preventive Medicine clarified on Saturday. Panic over dengue gripped the campus, with scores of students turning up for blood tests.

The 20-year-old hostel inmate came to the Kalaingar Centenary Super Speciality Hospital in Guindy on Thursday with four days of high-grade fever and was referred to the KMCH the same day. He died the next day. "Diagnosis: scrub typhus. No dengue diagnosis. It's a single reported case," the department posted on X.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8

Shri Thawarchand Gehlot
His Excellency
Governor of Karnataka

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• M.Sc. Nursing
• Phd
• NPCC
- AYUSH**
(UG, PG & Phd in)
Number of Colleges 150
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• Homoeopathy
• Unani
• Yoga & Naturopathy
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• Sowa Rigpa
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• M.Pharm
• Pharm.D (Post Baccalaureate)
• Phd
- ALLIED HEALTH SCIENCES**
Number of Colleges 276
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• M.Sc. Allied Health Sciences
• Phd
- PHYSIOTHERAPY**
Number of Colleges 169
• BPT
• MPT
• Phd
- DENTAL SCIENCES**
Number of Colleges 37
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• MDS
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- Research Grants for Students and Faculty
- RAGUPAT – Placement & Training: Strengthening skill development, finishing programmes and global career opportunities for students and graduates

TRANSFORMING SOCIETY BEYOND CLASSROOMS – KEY INITIATIVES

- Nasha Mukta Campus Abhiyan
- Organ Donation Pledge Abhiyan
- Palliative Care Curriculum Training for Faculty
- Divine Mother – Child Program
- Raktha Kosha
- BLS & Jeeva Raksha Training
- Disaster Management Network Across Karnataka
- Research, Innovation and Academic Collaboration with the Indian Institute of Science (IISc)
- Smart Mentor Programme – Empowering Students through Digital Mentorship
- Institution-Wide Digital Transformation Program

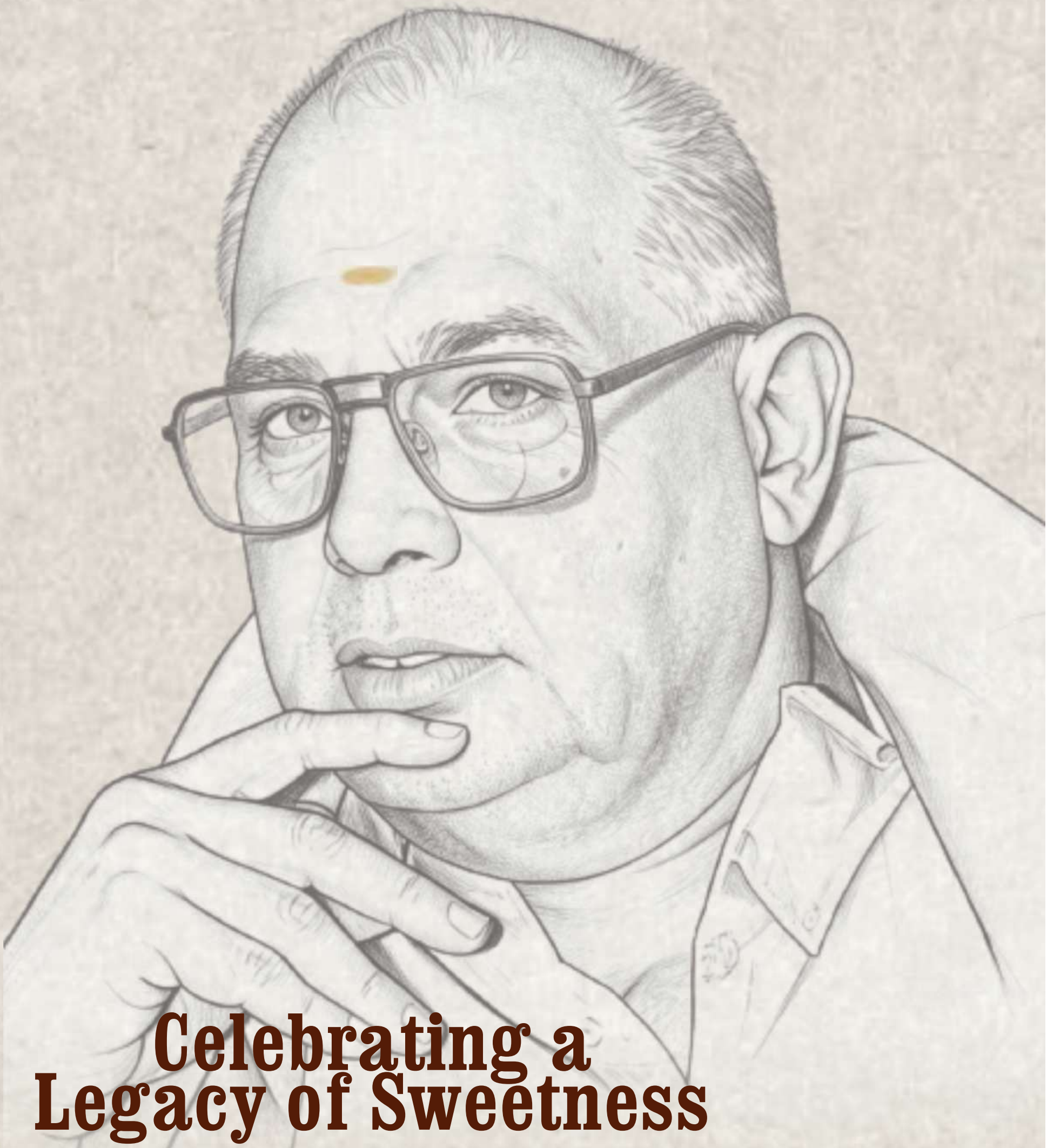
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GCC councillors complain about rise in dengue cases

They demand additional manpower for mosquito control; GCC has cleared breeding sources from 1,635 educational institutions so far, conducted medical camps, and intensified fogging operations

CITY MATTERS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) councillors have complained about a rise in mosquito density on the premises of educational institutions and open spaces in various wards of the city. Corporation Public Health Standing Committee chairperson G. Shanthakumari said the GCC had registered 654 dengue cases in September so far. At the Public Health Committee meeting held on Friday, councillors demanded that the GCC increase manpower for mosquito control. “Owing to Census operations, sector workers shouldered additional responsibility, and subsequently, mosquito control work was affected in some areas. Sanitary officers and inspectors have also been



Vector vice: The Corporation has registered 654 dengue cases in September so far, with 258 registered this week. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

given additional responsibility of conservancy. This has affected public health. The mosquito density has increased in the city. Councillors have pointed to the rise in dengue cases in many hospitals,” they said. On Saturday, the Corporation began a drive to reduce mosquito density in educational institutions across the city. GCC Com-

missioner G.S. Sameeran said: “Of the 3,103 educational institutions in the city, 1,635 have been covered so far. The remaining work will be taken up next week. A team of workers, along with sanitary inspectors, will visit each institution to check domestic breeding.” “Today, we covered 1,976 premises within 231 colleges, schools, and oth-

er institutions, through a mass programme. Out of these, 90 were schools and 159 were hostels. On these premises, 592 containers showed mosquito breeding. All were destroyed,” he said. “We have conducted an extensive search for breeding sources and deployed additional manpower to identify hidden sources and clear them. Today alone, we removed 655 kg of unwanted materials and 82 kg of tyres – all of which could be potential breeding sources – from Anna University. Similarly, mass source reduction programmes have been conducted in 90 schools. A total of 258 dengue cases have been reported this week,” Dr. Sameeran said. **Medical camps held** The GCC also conducted medical camps at 48 locations across the city on Saturday. The civic body has also intensified fogging operations.

Tasmac employees at retail outlets across State to wear uniform from November 15

Sangeetha Kandavel
CHENNAI

From November 15, employees working at retail vending shops operated by the Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation Limited (Tasmac) will be required to report for duty in uniforms prescribed by the government. Supervisors will wear light blue shirts with navy blue trousers, while salesmen and assistant salesmen will wear beige shirts with dark grey trousers. Each employee will get three sets of uniforms. “Having regard to the nature of the duties performed by the personnel of the Tasmac Retail Vending Shops, and the need to maintain a uniform, neat and professional appearance at the shops, it has been considered appro-



The new uniforms approved for Tasmac supervisors (left) and salesmen and assistant salesmen (right). SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



prate to implement a uniform concept for them,” according to a message that was sent to all senior regional managers and district managers of Tasmac. “The cloth will be supplied through Co-optex,” said Minister for Prohibition and Excise K. Vignesh. The Tasmac emblem shall be affixed to the left

chest area of the shirt. The procurement of the cloth shall be completed on or before October 31, and the tailoring and stitching of all the three sets shall be completed on or before November 10. If there are practical difficulties in procuring, stitching, and distributing uniforms across the State,

employees will receive a uniform allowance of ₹2,000 per set annually for three sets. The allowance will cover both the cost of the cloth and stitching. The uniform allowance shall be credited to the bank account of each eligible employee on the first day of April every year. In 2019, employees working at Elite Tasmac outlets were given uniforms, including a blazer. But the project did not take off. As on July 2026, Tasmac has 4,048 retail vending shops and a workforce of 22,877 (6,473 supervisors, 14,379 salespersons, and 2,025 assistant salespersons). For the year 2025-2026, the cash cow of the Tamil Nadu government earned a revenue of ₹50,845 crore.

39-year-old man absconding for 19 years after arrest in murder case held in Thirumullaivoyal

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 39-year-old man wanted in connection with a 2007 murder case in Tiruvottiyur was arrested after absconding for 19 years following a court warrant. The police identified the accused as Sheikh Abdul-

lah, 39, of Thirumullaivoyal. He was among five persons arrested in 2007 in connection with the murder of Pandiyamani in Tiruvottiyur and was remanded in judicial custody. After securing bail, Abdullah failed to appear before the Fourth Additional Court in Ponneri, Ti-

ruvallur district. In 2010, the court issued a warrant for his arrest and production. A special team from the Serious Crime Squad North, under the supervision of an Assistant Commissioner of Police, launched a search for Abdullah. The team used his

photograph taken at the time of his arrest to generate updated images of his appearance. After gathering information, the team kept him under surveillance and arrested him at Thirumullaivoyal. Abdullah was produced before the court and remanded in judicial custody.

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Piped water supply to be suspended in zones 13, 14

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Piped water supply will be suspended to parts of zones 13 and 14 from Sunday to September 29 to enable the shifting of a pipeline for the construction of a storm-water drain (SWD) in Sholinganallur. A press release from the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board said the major pipeline, which conveys water from the 150 MLD desalination plant at Nemmeli, would be shifted to facilitate the construction of the SWD on TNHB-A Main Road. Piped water supply to areas, including parts of Velachery, Ullagaram Puzhuthivakkam, Madipakkam, Pallikaranai, and Jalladianpet, would be suspended. However, the agency has proposed supplying water from the Chembarambakkam water treatment plant as an alternative source.

Timings CHENNAI			
SUNDAY, SEP. 20			
RISE	05:58	SET	18:07
RISE	13:40	SET	00:17
MONDAY, SEP. 21			
RISE	05:58	SET	18:06
RISE	14:26	SET	01:10
TUESDAY, SEP. 22			
RISE	05:58	SET	18:05
RISE	15:09	SET	02:02

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	38	25
Chennai Airport	37	28
Chennai City	37	27

Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light to moderate rain and thunder-shower to occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm. Night also will be comfortable. Spell of rain and thundershower to occur.

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THE HINDU
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TAMIL NADU

A stone cold PERPETRATOR

An influential industrialist now finds himself at the centre of a widening investigation under the POCSO Act into the allegations of paedophilia. While he was under investigation from last year, a fresh probe, ordered by the court, led the police to recover additional digital evidence and identify multiple victims. **R. Sivaraman** examines what has been labelled the ‘Epstein case of Tamil Nadu’, only to discover that while the scale of operations was nowhere near that of the American offender, a subterranean network of sexual abusers and their enablers did operate for years

For decades, R. Veeramani, 84, known as ‘Gem Granite’ Veeramani, was celebrated as one of the architects of India’s granite industry. He helped build the sector’s institutional framework, headed industry bodies, and was honoured by the Union government for his contribution to granite mining and marketing. He was also known for his philanthropic activities.

Veeramani, a lawyer, entered the natural stone industry by chance and went on to become one of its pioneers. He built a multi-core business and carefully cultivated a social circle that included politicians, celebrities, and other public figures. There seemed to have been another side to him though. Today, the Greater Chennai Police are investigating charges that he has sexually assaulted minor girls. The case took a dramatic turn after a Special Court for POCSO Act cases last month rejected an earlier police report seeking to close the investigation and ordered further inquiries.

Origin of the case

The case originated with a complaint filed by a child rights activist of an NGO based at Anna Nagar, Chennai, with the Inspector of the Immoral Traffic Prevention Unit (ITPU) on October 6, 2025.

The complaint was forwarded by the then Additional Commissioner of the Central Crime Branch (CCB) for further action. The following day, the CCB registered a case under Sections 7 and 8 of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act and it was forwarded to the Assistant Commissioner of the ITPU on October 9.

According to the complaint, while the activist was at her office, an unidentified person handed over a cover containing a message and a pen drive. A man (later identified as Veeramani) was seen hugging a minor girl, touching her inappropriately, and sexually abusing her on a bed at a house belonging to Shanthi, described as his associate.

The police officer who initially investigated the case found that a search of the house mentioned in the complaint or shown in the video reportedly did not yield any evidence of wrongdoing on the part of persons named in the complaint.

On February 20, 2026, the Assistant Commissioner, ITPU, filed a report before the court recommending that further action be dropped. According to the report, the video appeared to show an incident that had taken place in 2019.

The police examined a digital video recorder (DVR) from the suspected location with the assistance of an authorised cyber-forensic expert. However, the investigators said they could not recover the original recording or any other relevant footage from the device.

The earlier report cited several difficulties, including the police’s inability to identify the girl in the video, the absence of usable CCTV footage, and the lack of statements from Shanthi’s neighbours. It also stated that the cyber-forensic expert could not retrieve the original recording from the DVR because approximately six years had passed since the alleged incident.

During the inquiry, Veeramani and Shanthi were questioned. Veeramani denied that he was the person seen in the video and said he did not know the person who appeared in the footage with a girl who seemed to be a minor. Shanthi, on the other hand, said she knew Veeramani but did not know the girl. She also stated that the location shown in the footage was not part of her house.

The report stated that the age and identity of the person resembling a minor in the video could not be established and there were no grounds to proceed further at that stage. The case was therefore classified as ‘Further Action Dropped’ and the report was submitted to the court. The police added that further action would be taken if new evidence or witnesses emerged.

However, the Special Court rejected the report and ordered further investigation, following which the inquiry was reopened in July 2026. During the fresh inquiry, the police searched Shanthi’s residence at Teynampet and recovered what they described as the original footage of the alleged sexual assault from an electronic device, a letter said to be written by Shanthi, and mobile records. Investigators also found indications of an attempt to destroy evidence. The seized device



We registered the case immediately after receiving the video. There was no laxity in the probe. Since the visuals were unclear, we could not identify the victim. Without identifying the victim, we could not proceed further

A SENIOR POLICE OFFICER

es were sent for forensic examination.

In a statement issued on August 29, the Greater Chennai Police said the person seen in the video stored on the pen drive had been identified as Veeramani. They added that Veeramani had rented a house at Teynampet and entrusted its management to Shanthi and her husband Mahendran Simhan. Investigators alleged that several minor girls had been brought to the house and sexually assaulted. The police also said video evidence relating to one such incident had been seized.

During the searches of the homes and offices of suspected individuals, the police recovered evidence, including photographs of minor girls connected with the incidents. Shanthi, 55, Mahendran Simhan, 60, and Veeramani were arrested and remanded in judicial custody. The police alleged that Shanthi and her husband had assisted in the offences. The investigation continued. A senior police officer said Shanthi’s alleged role could be broadly compared with that of Ghislaine Maxwell (in Jeffrey Epstein’s case), who was convicted for facilitating the sexual abuse of minors.

Victim identified

Last week, the police investigating the POCSO Act case identified the minor girl allegedly assaulted by Veeramani. She was 12 years old at the time of the alleged incident. The survivor’s statement was recorded before a Judicial Magistrate. She identified herself and Veeramani in the video.

The police subsequently traced and identified three more victims, all of whom were aged 12-15 at the time of the incidents. Sources said more victims came forward to record their statements on the assaults by the prime accused after being assured that their identities would be kept secret.

Greater Chennai Police Commissioner A. Amalraj said, “We strictly follow the guidelines while handling such cases. Tracing the victims took time, and the investigation is being conducted in accordance with the procedures prescribed by law. After conducting a thorough investigation, we will file a charge sheet in time and get conviction.”

During the investigation, the police also unearthed the case of suicide of a minor girl in early 2003, linked to Veeramani. Shanthi’s message to Veeramani stated that a child had ended her life because of him.

Minors targeted

A senior police officer said Veeramani had targeted girls aged 12-16 over several years. The officer said he lured children by offering small amounts of money, sports shoes, chocolates, and mobile phones.

Sources said Veeramani encouraged children to enter the premises of his bungalow as he remained in the portico, pretending to play ball. The children used to pick up balls tossed around. He used to give them chocolates and eatables when they entered his premises but targetted only the girls for exploitation. He would pick the targets, ask their names, and give them his phone number, saying that they could approach him for any assistance, including financial help. If they contacted him, he would reportedly send a driver to bring them to the bungalow. He would take them to his bedroom and the victims were then sexually assaulted. He had given them amounts ranging from ₹2,000 to ₹5,000. If a victim complained that it was too low, the payment was increased, in some instances to ₹50,000. Sometimes, he gave the

girls mobile phones or sports shoes. The officer also alleged that Veeramani invited children to parties at hotels, transported them in luxury cars, and then sexually assaulted them. This went on for years.

Back entrance and secret room

Police sources further said the victims had identified the back entrance, the bedroom of his bungalow, and the secret room in his office. An officer also said Shanthi had claimed she was raped by Veeramani when she was 13 and she had a son from him. Police sources said she was seeking a share of Veeramani’s property. They also said Shanthi was trained as an architect and was now running a dance school. She and her husband had served as directors of a company owned by Veeramani and were on his payroll.

When contacted, there was no response from Veeramani’s side to the allegations against him. Police sources said the investigation had only begun and they suspect more revelations would emerge.

Dismissing allegations that the investigation had been subverted last year, a senior officer who had earlier served in the Commissionerate said, “We registered the case immediately after receiving the video. There was no laxity in the investigation. Since the visuals were unclear, we could not identify the victim. Without identifying the victim, we could not proceed further, but we did not close the case. Had we identified the victim, we would have taken the investigation forward.”

It is learnt that a report on the status of the case was filed in February to comply with the prescribed legal time frame. The report did not seek closure of the case. The officer said the case was kept open, with the provision that the investigation could be revived if any fresh evidence emerged.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State’s health helpline 104, Tele-MANAS 14416, and Sneha’s suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050.)



ILLUSTRATION: SAAI

Minister calls for more awareness, sensitive communication about dementia treatment

Families should be able to find answers to practical questions on identifying symptoms, seeking help

Various places in north and delta districts, including Chennai, Villupuram, Pudukottai and Nagapattinam, may come under the path of rain-bearing sys-

Police Commissioner A. Amalraj directed officials to ensure that the processions were conducted peacefully and without any untoward incidents.

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Tender No.15-02. Improvements to roads in A.M. Nagar & Extension, Ganesh Nagar, EB Nagar, Arun Sankar Nagar, Arief Maricar Nagar and Saraa Ummat Nagar in Karaikal District. Estimate Cost: Rs.8,22,95,760/- (inclusive of GST). Earnest Money: Rs.16,45,915/- Period of Completion: 12 (Twelve) Months (Including Monsoon period).	
Tender No.15-03. Improvements to the internal road connecting Sivaji Nagar and Mariammam Kovil street in Karaikal. Estimate Cost: Rs.4,32,61,192/- (inclusive of GST). Earnest Money: Rs.8,65,224/- Period of Completion: Nine (9) Months (Including Monsoon period).	
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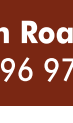
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Innovations in the treatment of blood cancers in children



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Dr. Revathi Raj

Senior Consultant - Paediatric
Haematology Oncology,

Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Teynampet

The story of treatment of children with blood cancer has been one of hope and innovations. Small baby steps have now turned into giant leaps and over 90% of children are now cured! How did we achieve this tremendous progress over the last fifty years?

Advances in diagnosis

With the advent of a technique called flow cytometry we can now obtain rapid diagnosis of blood cancers. The use of Measurable Residual Disease or MRD has now helped us identify one in one million cancer cells after the initial therapy and guides further therapy. We can now detect the tumour DNA through Next Generation Sequencing – NGS and help with precision diagnosis.

Advances in supportive care

We have now trained our physicians and nurses to look after children undergoing cancer therapy chemotherapy, radiotherapy and surgery and all specialists deliver care with the child at the centre. Infection control measures and newer antibiotics and antifungals help fight bacteria, viruses and fungi that can harm an immunocompromised child. The generous donation of blood and platelets from voluntary donors provide life saving blood products.

Advances in therapy

Cancer cells can now be treated using targeted therapy such as Blinatumomab and Inotuzumab. These agents specifically target the leukaemic cells and spare normal cells and can eliminate cells that are resistant to conventional chemotherapy. CAR-T cells are the innovation of the century where the child's own lymphocytes are genetically altered to fight the cancer cells. These are now available in India commercially produced with our own vectors thereby reducing costs.

Advances in data sharing

Childhood leukaemia trials such as ICICLE in India have pioneered advances by sharing all the knowledge gained by treating children across the country. The children are given standard treatment and the data is analysed to help improve the outcomes one step at a time.

Advances in preventing long term complications

We are now focussing on risk adapted therapy to prevent late side effects. Newer protocols always include prevention of late effects and reducing the use of radiotherapy and drugs that can potentially affect fertility and heart function.

Advances in access to care

No child should be allowed to abandon therapy due to lack of access to care based on their financial background. Several Government and non-government organisations have reached out to help children with cancer. Simple interventions such as providing a Home Away from Home to help complete long treatments at the cancer centre, Bridge Funding and schemes for purchasing life-saving drugs have helped reduce the rates of abandonment.

Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Teynampet

No. 320, Anna Salai,
Teynampet, Chennai-35

☎ 044 6115 1111

✉ infochennai@apollohospitals.com

INBRIEF



Governor Arlekar takes part in beach-cleaning activity

Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar took part in a beach-cleaning activity under Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar 5.0 on the occasion of the International Coastal Clean-up Day at the Marina on Saturday. Mr. Arlekar flagged off the beach-cleaning activity and removed litter from the sand. According to a release, he emphasised the importance of keeping beaches and coastal ecosystems clean. The Governor also interacted with volunteers and students during the beach-cleaning activity.

Commerce Department of MCC hosts alumni meet

The Department of Commerce (Aided) of Madras Christian College hosted its Global Alumni Meet on Saturday. Principal P. Wilson addressed the gathering, according to a press release. Arun Mammen, vice-chairman and managing director of MRF Limited, was the guest of honour. Head of the Department Vijayakumari Joseph acknowledged the contributions of founders and senior professors. Alumni Matthew proposed the establishment of the Mr. Swaminathan Endowment Fund, and Rakesh Stanley reminisced about his college days.

‘India is entering a period of economic growth that could be unparalleled in our history’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

India is entering a period of economic growth that could be “unparalleled in our own history and unparalleled with any part of the world”; even as artificial intelligence (AI), technology, and regulatory change reshape the global economy, this growth could continue for several decades, said Natarajan Chandrasekaran, Chairman of Tata Sons.

Delivering his convocation address at Sai University on Saturday, Mr. Chandrasekaran told the students: “You are stepping into a world that has changing global economic conditions, technological challenges, disruptive AI-led revolutions, regulatory framework, and other changes that are constantly evolving.”

Job losses due to AI

On job losses due to AI, he said technology was also opening up new areas of opportunity. “The world is full to the brim with possibilities. And five years from now, there will be industries that don’t exist today,” he said.

He told the students that when they step out into the world at large, they would start to feel the pressure. “There will be goals, targets, and things to achieve and you will work to achieve them. You will feel the pressure till you



Tata Sons Chairman Natarajan Chandrasekaran presenting the degree to a student at Sai University's convocation. K.V. Ramani, founder and chancellor of the university, is seen. R. RAVINDRAN

achieve, and whether in the corporate world or academia... to earn the right to feel the pressure is a privilege,” he said.

‘Pressure is a privilege’

Mr. Chandrasekaran said 26 years ago, a young tennis player Lindsay Davenport was about to compete in the finals of the 2000 Fed Cup. “Lindsay asked the legendary tennis star Billie Jean King for advice. She simply said to her: ‘you are feeling the pressure and pressure is a privilege’. What she meant was by reaching the finals against the world number one, Davenport had earned the right to feel the pressure. It also meant there were great expectations from her and with her talent and performance, she had a real chance to win,” he said.

He urged graduates to adopt a mindset of “running dual races”, working towards long-term goals while pursuing short-term

achievements to maintain momentum. Citing marathon races, he said individuals should measure themselves against their own progress rather than comparing themselves with others. He also quoted marathon runner Juma Ikgangaa: “The will to win means nothing without the will to prepare.”

K.V. Ramani, founder and chancellor of Sai University, said that when he started this university, there were questions about the need for another university. “If we have 2,000 universities, then why do we have seven lakh students going abroad for higher education? Why let the cream of students from India leave? This was my thought,” he said.

Mr. Ramani also said the graduating students had unique education combination, such as Computer Science with Psychology. Degrees were conferred on 72 graduating students at the ceremony.

Man arrested for setting woman on fire

CHENNAI: The police arrested M. Babulal, 40, for allegedly setting a 32-year-old woman on fire near Washermanpet on Friday night, allegedly over a dispute in their relationship. The woman, M. Mohana, suffered about 50% burns and is undergoing treatment at Kilpauk Medical College Hospital.

Five accused in Armstrong murder case granted bail

They have been granted bail as the CBI is yet to file a final report and they have spent over two years in prison; judge says the probe remains at FIR stage after earlier final report was quashed

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

Five persons accused in the murder of Bahujan Samaj Party leader K. Armstrong have been granted mandatory bail on the ground that the Central Bureau of Investigation is yet to file a final report, while they have been in prison for more than two years without the trial commencing.

Sources said almost all those arrested and remanded in connection with the case have now been enlarged on bail.

On the evening of July 5, 2024, Armstrong was hacked to death by a gang of nine members. Armstrong was rushed to Apollo Hospital, Greaves Road, but died on the way.

Based on a complaint, the Sembium police registered a case and formed special teams. The suspects were arrested in quick succession. A total of 30 people, including three women, were cited as accused. Gangsters Nagen-



K. Armstrong

dran and Sambav Senthil were among them. Nagen-dran later died of ill health, while another accused, Thiruvenkadam, was killed in an encounter. Sambav Senthil and his associate Mottai Krishnan remain absconding.

On September 24, 2025, the Madras High Court quashed the charge sheet filed by the Sembium police and transferred the investigation to the CBI, citing concerns over the thoroughness and impartiality of the State police probe. The State government later withdrew its challenge before the Supreme Court.

Meanwhile, more than

15 accused, including Aswathaman, were enlarged on bail. The CBI took over the case and re-registered it as R.C. No. 09/S/2026 on August 6, 2026. Five more accused, including Manna alias Manivannan, subsequently approached the Principal Sessions Court seeking bail.

Long incarceration

The defence counsel, Muthamizh Selvan, submitted that the accused had been in judicial custody for more than two years and that the earlier charge sheet had been quashed. He argued that the CBI had not examined any witness for a considerable period after taking over the probe and that continued incarceration violated the accused's right to a speedy investigation and trial.

The CBI Special Public Prosecutor opposed the petitions, submitting that the agency was actively investigating the case, including examining and re-examining crucial witnesses and scrutinising

electronic records, financial transactions and the roles of untraced co-conspirators. Granting bail at this stage would jeopardise the investigation into the remaining conspiratorial links, the prosecutor submitted.

Allowing the bail petitions, Principal Sessions Judge B. Karthikeyan observed that the CBI did not appear to have examined even a single witness during the month preceding the hearing. The judge noted that the earlier investigation had recorded the statements of 237 witnesses and said the extent of the material now before the CBI indicated the enormity of the task facing the agency.

“It does not appear that investigation would be completed in a short time,” the judge observed. The judge also noted that the accused had already spent more than two years in custody and that the investigation remained at the FIR stage after the earlier final report was quashed.



Justice M.M. Sundresh, Supreme Court judge, handing over a degree certificate to a student at Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science on Saturday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

True character lies in getting back up after failure, says SC judge

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Supreme Court judge Justice M.M. Sundresh conferred degrees on the students of Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science (HITS) at the 17th convocation ceremony held here on Saturday.

Speaking at the event, Justice Sundresh said failure was a wonderful thing. While it is only natural for all of us to fall down, true character lies in getting back up, he said. He urged students to be innovative, imaginative, and to treat everyone with dignity.

Gokul V. Subramaniam, president of Intel India, said, “We are in the middle

of a huge paradigm shift; every day, technology is evolving. You are inheriting a world defined by the rapid evolution of deep tech and artificial intelligence. But with that immense computing power comes a profound responsibility that we owe to our planet and humanity.”

Anand Jacob Verghese, chancellor of HITS, said convocation was one of the most significant occasions in a student's life.

Vikas Misra, vice-chancellor of HITS; Akhilesh Mishra, former ambassador to Ireland and Maldives; and Oscar Concesao of Oscar, Ponni, Rahul Architects, Chennai, spoke.

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GREEN BELT	₹ 14,750	26, 27 September 3, 4, 10, 11, 17 & 18 October 2026 (WEEKEND)
BLACK BELT	₹ 22,125	26, 27 September 3, 4, 10, 11, 17, 18, 24 25 & 31 October 1 November 2026 (WEEKEND)
ROOT CAUSE ANALYST	₹ 2,950	12, 13, 14, 15 & 16 October 2026 (WEEKDAY)
LEAN CHAMPION	₹ 7,375	14,15,16,21,22 & 23 October 2026 (WEEKDAY)
5S AUDITOR	₹ 7,375	18, 19, 20, 25, 26, 27 November 2026 (WEEKDAY)

COURSE	FEES (incl GST)	CLASSROOM TRAINING DATES
YELLOW BELT	₹ 5,900	10, 11 October 2026 (WEEKEND)
GREEN BELT	₹ 17,700	10, 11, 17, 18 October 2026 (WEEKEND)
BLACK BELT	₹ 29,500	10, 11, 17, 18, 24, 25 October 2026 (WEEKEND)

Timings : Classroom : 10.00 AM - 5.30 PM, Online : 07 PM - 10 PM, Weekday Online : 8.00 PM - 10 PM
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कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, खूँटी
ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- RDD/SD/KHUNTI/04/2026-27

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	खूँटी जिला के रनियाँ प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत जयपुर पंचायत में पिडुल से टालडा जाने वाले पथ में सिकरिया नाला पर पुल निर्माण।	4,02,79,800 /-	8,06,000 /-	10,000 /-	18 माह

1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि - 05.10.2026
2. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय-दिनांक 05.10.2026 से दिनांक 12.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
3. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान - कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, खूँटी
4. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय -14.10.2026 अपराह्न 12:30 बजे
5. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले वेबसाइट का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, खूँटी।
6. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० - 7992312702 (संबंधित कार्यलय का दूरभाष नम्बर)
7. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है हदुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
8. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुगान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यलय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
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PR 390127 Rural Development(26-27).D

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Bid Ref. No.JMC/NIT-26/Drugs/08 Date:18-09-2026
Rate Contract for Supply of MEDICINE from the GMP Certified manufacturers.
The Managing Director, Jharkhand Medical & Health Infrastructure Development & Procurement Corporation Limited (JMHDPC), Ranchi hereby invites separate Technical Bid and Financial Bid (two envelope system) through e-procurement from eligible manufacturer Rate Contract for Supply Medicines.
The Bid documents with detailed conditions can be viewed and downloaded through website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in and should be submitted through e-procurement system only. The eligible Bidder(s) willing to participate must be registered in e-procurement portal.

Particulars	Date & Time
Name of Work	Rate Contract for Supply of Medicine
Time of Completion	Within 60 days after issue of work order
Date of Publication of Bid	21-09-2026
Pre-bid Meeting	29-09-2026 03:00 PM
Bid Submission Start Date	05-10-2026
Bid Submission Closing Date & Time	22-10-2026 05:00 PM
Bid Opening Date for Technical Proposal	23-10-2026 05:00 PM
Date of Opening of Financial Proposal	To be notified later
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs 200000/- (Online Payment Gateway)
Contact/ Helpline No. of E-Procurement Cell	+91-6387370230

Note: The above dates may change due to declaration of holidays. In the event of any of the dates being declared as a holiday for the office of the JMHDPC, the Bids will be opened on the next working day at the appointed time.
JMHDPC reserves the right to amend or withdraw any of the terms and conditions contained in the Bid document including quantity/ number of Medicines to be supplied or to reject any or all Bids without giving any notice or assigning any reason. The decision of the Managing Director, JMHDPC in this regard shall be final.
PR 390120 Jharkhand Medical & Health Infrastructure Dev & Procurement Corp Ltd(26-27)#D
Sd/- Managing Director, JMHDPC

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE
DEATH
OBITUARY
Mrs. Susila Srinivasa Murthy
Born : 13.12.1925 Died : 05.09.2026
Mrs. Susila Srinivasa Murthy, aged 100 years, Passed away peacefully in Adyar, Chennai to reach the lotus feet of the Lord on 05th Sep 2026 Remarkably, she held a Masters in Sanskrit in 1947 - and spent a lifetime of love, looking after her family as the consummate homemaker. She was married to her late husband GS Murthy for a good 71 years.
Susila is survived by: Sons, Sriram Murthi & Arun Murthi.(Usha Murthi)
Grandchildren: Prianca and Grant Spencer Murthi. Rohan and Grant Jay Murthi.
Predeceased by: Husband G S Murthy, Daughter in-law: Kathleen Murthi
Brothers : S Kunjithapadam (Sulochana) R S Srinivasan
Sisters: R Visalam (Ramanathan) R Lalitha S Chinnapeya

DEATH
OBITUARY
Sitalakshmi (Age 93yrs)
W/o. Late N Muthukrishnan
Passed away peacefully on 19 Sep 2026 morning in Chennai.
She is survived by her loving Sons, Daughters and Grand Children. Venkataaraman & Rama, Rajeswari & Raman, Bhavani & Narasimhan, Kalyani & Hariharan, Sivakumar & Aarthi and their families
Ph: 98410 86035

DEATH
ANNIVERSARIES
37th ANNIVERSARY
Smt. Krishnaveni Ammal
W / o. Late Sri. M. Govindarajan
Tenderly Remembered by Family Members & Staff of BOOTIS BROCHES, BOOTIS UDYOG, VIRGO ENGINEERS, Chennai.

SAD DEMISE
D.O.B - 19.01.1938 D.O.D -19.09.2026
Ariyakudi Shri. L Srinivasan
Carburendum Universal Ltd & LCC City Branch - III
Deeply Mourned by: Mrs.S.Deivanai (Wife) Dr.S.Venkatachalam (Son) Dr.R.Vidya (Daughter-in-Law) Mrs.Akamelu Palaniappan (Daughter) Dr.S.Palanisappan (Son-in-Law) Dr.Archna (Grand daughter) Dr.N.Raja (grand son in law) Adv. Hanrikristna Palaniappan (Grand son) Abhinav Venkatachalam (Grand Son)
Final Rites at Tiruvottiyur Nagaratnar Chathiram, South Madra street, Chennai - 600 019 on Sunday 20.09.26 at 11 am.
Please Contact: 89397 33461 (Son) 94431 03116 (Daughter)

THIRD ANNIVERSARY
In loving memory of
S.NAGAPPAN
14-05-1933 - 20.09.2023
Chief Accounts Officer (Retd.)
Department of Treasuries and Accounts Government of Tamilnadu
You are in our thoughts every day and in our hearts forever.
Finally remembered by: N. Ramesh Premkumar, N. Suresh Balaji, Daughters-in-law, Grandchildren, Friends and Relatives.



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*Participating banks and apps

From Page One

Anna varsity student did not die due to dengue, clarifies govt.

The post came after social media and some television channels reported that there had been a dengue outbreak, which had led to three deaths.

The news triggered alarm on campus and students rushed to a primary health centre for tests. A medical officer said that for the past 15 days, around 80 students had turned up in the mornings and around 50 in the evenings with general presentation of fever and cold. The deceased student reported at the health centre with similar symptoms on September 14 and, as per protocol, a complete blood count (CBC) was done on the third day of fever on September 16. The CBC report recorded a count of 1.38 lakh platelets, which ruled out dengue, but the patient did not turn up to collect his report, the doctor added.

“I do not know what happened between then (September 16) and Friday. Besides, ours is only a primary health centre. We carry out blood tests and refer students as soon as they return with any findings,” the doctor said. In the past few weeks, around five cases of dengue have been detected on campus. “The students were referred immediately. They have since recovered and have been discharged,” he added.

Till about midday on Saturday, around 70 students turned up for screening at the health centre as soon as the news of dengue outbreak broke. The university authorities said they had been allaying fears and had started screening students for scrub typhus as well, along with dengue and leptospirosis.

Screening camp and sanitation drive

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has set up a special screening camp for hostel inmates, the medical officer informed. In addition, GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran inspected intensive sanitation and mosquito-control work being carried out at the Anna University campus in Guindy. A total of 100 workers were engaged in sanitation operations, including the removal of accumulated garbage and waste and the implementation of mosquito-control measures, a press release said.

Dr. Sameeran reviewed the ongoing work and instructed officials to ensure that garden waste and garbage were cleared from the campus, and the premises were kept clean, the release said. He also directed officials to prevent water stagnation to curb mosquito breeding and to carry out mosquito-control fogging operations. Officials were further instructed to continuously monitor students and provide appropriate treatment wherever required, the release added.

According to the release, Dr. Sameeran also instructed officials to undertake similar sanitation measures at all educational institutions across Chennai.

INBRIEF



TMC(M) authorises Vasan to take a call on byelections

The office-bearers of the Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) (TMC(M)) have empowered party president G.K. Vasan to take a call on the party’s position on the byelections to the Madurantakam and Dharapuram constituencies. A release from the party said Mr. Vasan held a meeting with district presidents and State-level office-bearers of the party. They empowered Mr. Vasan to decide whether to extend support to any formation. The party is likely to announce its position in two days. The TMC(M) was part of the AIADMK-led National Democratic Alliance in the 2026 Assembly elections.

DMK functionary, Sub-Registrar among six booked for alleged land fraud in Srirangam

The six accused had allegedly committed the crime fully aware that the land belonged to the Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple; four of the accused had claimed that they owned the over 7,000-sq.ft land in Srirangam and used forged documents to transfer it to the name of the DMK functionary

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI

The Tiruchi City Crime Branch (CCB) has launched an investigation after registering a case against a DMK functionary, a Sub-Registrar, and four other private individuals in connection with an alleged case of cheating and land fraud involving a portion of land that belongs to the Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple in Srirangam during 2022-23.

The charges against the six accused are that they entered into a criminal conspiracy to commit the alleged crime, which led to the temple land being registered illegally in the name of N. Ramkumar, the DMK’s Srirangam area se-

cretary, by using forged documents. The six accused had allegedly committed the crime fully aware that the land belonged to the temple.

The case was registered on September 13 by the CCB, which was acting on a complaint lodged by the temple’s Joint Commissioner/Executive Officer S. Sivaramkumar.

The case has been registered under Sections 420 (cheating and dishonestly inducing delivery of property); 465 (forgery); 467 (forgery of valuable security, will), 468 (forgery for purpose of cheating); 471 (using as genuine a forged document or electronic record), and 120B (criminal conspiracy) of the Indian Penal Code.



I had received repeated complaints that the DMK’s Srirangam area secretary had illegally transferred a portion of land belonging to the temple in his name and was using it as the party office

S. RAMESH
HR&CE Minister

The extent of the temple land that was illegally transferred is a little over 7,000 sq.ft in Srirangam. Police sources said the four private individuals, who claimed to own the land, had registered it illegally in the name of Ramkumar using the forged documents. The amount received in

told reporters in Srirangam that he had received repeated complaints from the public stating that the DMK’s Srirangam area secretary had illegally transferred a portion of land belonging to the temple in his name and was using it as the party office. The HR&CE Department conducted inquiries and collected evidence, he said, adding that it was established that the land belonged to the Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple.

The temple authorities had written a letter to the Sub-Registrar office at Srirangam stating that the land belonged to the temple. The DMK functionary used fabricated documents and provided false information that the land

had belonged to private individuals in order to get it registered in his name without the original deed, he said.

‘More persons involved’

Mr. Ramesh wondered how an ordinary DMK area secretary managed to deceive the Police, Revenue, HR&CE and Registration Departments. The value of the land is said to be ₹50 crore, he said, adding that this could not have been done without the intervention of some “influential people”.

Terming it a “big fraud”, he added that a complaint had been preferred to the police, along with the evidence, to register a case, and investigation was under way.

Bypolls are being conducted in T.N. because democracy has died: Stalin

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK leader and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin said on Saturday that Tamil Nadu is witnessing byelections to two Assembly constituencies because of the “death of democracy”.

“Normally, byelections are necessitated by the death of elected members. Now, democracy has died and caused the byelection,” he said while addressing the party’s Mupperum Vizha.

Mr. Stalin said the byelections to the Maduranthagam and Dharapuram constituencies had been imposed on voters even before the indelible ink on their fingers had disappeared. “How much arrogance should the ruling party have to force two



Hitting back: DMK president M.K. Stalin and other party leaders at the Mupperum Vizha held on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

elected members to resign and field them in the same constituencies? Is it a change? It is a shameful change,” he said.

Accusing the ruling TVK of running a “reels government”, Mr. Stalin said it had denigrated the dignity of the Assembly, which had completed its centenary. “You should see what is happening in the As-

sembly, and I am spared of it. I must thank the people of Kolathur constituency,” he said. Mr. Stalin said that instead of responding to the questions raised by DMK floor leader Udhayanidhi Stalin in the Assembly, Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay had sought to divert public attention by referring to his arrest under the Maintenance of Internal

Security Act (MISA) and the Sarkaria Commission.

“I need not prove my arrest under the MISA to anyone. No one is qualified to evaluate my sacrifice. There is the memoir of the late DMK leader Chittibabu, which remains as a stone inscription. There is also the report of the Justice Ismail Commission on excesses during the Emergency. If he can read, let him read the report,” he said.

Recalling Mr. Vijay’s question about his visits to foreign countries to attract investments, Mr. Stalin wondered why the Chief Minister had signed an MoU with an Indian company in the U.K. “What is the purpose of the visit without the Industries Minister and the Industries Secretary?” he asked.

Drop Pattinapakkam Secretariat project, Murugan urges govt.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Union Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting L. Murugan on Saturday urged the Tamil Nadu government to drop its plan to construct the new Assembly-Secretariat complex at Pattinapakkam in Chennai, saying it would affect the livelihood of fishermen in the area.

Speaking to reporters after participating in a *Rozgar Mela* in Chennai, Mr. Murugan said thousands of fishermen in the area have been dependent on fishing for their livelihood for several years.

The construction of a new Secretariat would put their livelihood at stake, the Minister said.

Referring to Mr. Vijay’s

movie *Sura*, Mr. Murugan said, “It is not enough to play the role of a fisherman in a film. He should understand the real pain and problems of fishermen and act accordingly.”

On Navodaya schools, Mr. Murugan said they were essential for improving the education of poor students.

He said the Supreme Court had directed the Tamil Nadu government to allot land for the schools and urged the government to establish Navodaya schools in all districts of the State.

He added that nobody had the right to prevent poor students from accessing education through Navodaya schools and the objective should be to ensure equal access to education for all.

PWD Minister tried to join AIADMK before the TVK: EPS

The Hindu Bureau
SALEM

AIADMK general secretary and former Chief Minister Edappadi K. Palaniswami alleged on Saturday that Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Aadhav Arjuna tried to join the AIADMK before the Tamilaga Vetti Kazhagam.

Mr. Palaniswami, who participated at a public meeting in Salem to mark former Chief Minister C.N. Annadurai’s birth anniversary, replied to Mr. Arjuna’s claims that the TVK would win in Edappadi

constituency if it contested on its symbol. Mr. Palaniswami said: “I won with the highest victory margin in Tamil Nadu, and the AIADMK won seven out of 11 seats in Salem district. The PWD Minister was in the DMK and later in the VCK. After that, he approached me to join the AIADMK and sought the deputy general secretary post. But we turned down the request, as only people working for the party would get the post.” After that, Mr. Arjuna joined the TVK and took “the party on lease”, he alleged.



AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami speaking at a public meeting in Salem on Saturday. E. LAKSHMI NARAYANAN

Following the Karur tragedy in which 41 people died, the TVK party office was closed for 15 days and Mr. Arjuna escaped to

another State, he charged.

Elaborating on the achievements of the AIADMK government in the past, Mr. Palaniswami

said the TVK had come to power accidentally, and it merely changed the names of schemes implemented by the AIADMK. The price of rice has increased by ₹15 to ₹20 per kg during the four months of the TVK-led government, and it has not taken any steps to reduce the price of essential commodities. “The DMK regime had already increased Tamil Nadu’s debts to ₹10 lakh crore, but the TVK-led government wants a new Secretariat. What is the need to build a new Secretariat at ₹1,200 crore when the government is

struggling with huge debts? And the site chosen for the project is an area where fishermen live,” he said.

Regarding Mr. Vijay’s recent visit to London, Mr. Palaniswami said companies already functioning in Tamil Nadu and in India signed MoUs in London. The TVK-led government should release a White Paper on how much investment it has attracted.

In the byelections in two Assembly constituencies, the AIADMK will win and teach a lesson to the ruling party, he added.

All-women rap crew puts the marginalised at centre of the climate debate

Geetha Srimathi
CHENNAI

A neem tree can be many things – a meeting point in the village, a place to sit under, rest, and escape the harsh afternoon sun for a few minutes. In *Veppa Marathadiyila*, Tamil Nadu’s first all-women rap crew, Sollisai Sistahs, turns that familiar image into a larger question: when the climate crisis arrives, who gets the shade?

The collective is known for songs that challenge social norms, particularly around caste and gender, while remaining rooted in the communities they come from. Their new Ta-

mil rap track is part of the *Climate Emergency Mixtape*, a multilingual hip-hop album that brings together six independent artists from across India to tell stories of the climate crisis in Tamil, Kannada, Marathi, and Hindi.

Rather than speaking about emission targets, degrees of warming and policy plans, the mixtape looks at climate change through lived experiences of people – water shortages, deforestation, resource exploitation, floods and the communities left to deal with the consequences.

For *Sollisai Sistahs*, the climate crisis is inseparable from questions of

caste, class, gender, and labour. In *Veppa Marathadiyila*, they turn their attention to people who are often missing from conversations around climate change, including workers, and marginalised communities who have the least control over the forces driving environmental degradation, but frequently bear its consequences.

“Climate change is still seen as an issue that is discussed only in ‘elite’ spaces. But who is getting affected the most? Marginalised communities,” says Abisha of Sollisai Sistahs.

The group had begun thinking about these ques-



Rappers Kavya and Abisha with Rani, a resident of Alangudi, who performed the folk portion of the track *Veppa Marathadiyila*.

tions a few years ago, when they worked with environmental organisation *Poovulagin Nanbargal* on a project around environmental issues. That engagement,

Ms. Abisha says, introduced them to another way of looking at the climate crisis as one deeply connected to inequality.

“If capitalist industries

are exploiting natural resources, and in turn affect the environment, tribal communities are the ones getting affected,” she says. “So, we have to speak out about these issues.”

Intersecting factors

That idea runs through *Veppa Marathadiyila*. The song looks at the intersection of climate, labour, and marginalisation, asking what is lost when floods and other climate-related disasters hit communities that have little room to absorb another shock. Its verses ask who is left carrying the loss, with questions like, “When a flood comes, whose houses collapse?

When a mountain crumbles, whose village disappears?”, and whether some of that loss could have been prevented through better planning.

“We shot the video in Alangudi village in Mayiladuthurai district. This was an idea by Sudharshan, who directed the video. We wanted to keep the climate conversation rooted in a landscape and community,” said Ms. Abisha.

The song opens with an elderly woman’s arresting voice before the rap kicks in. Rani, a resident of Alangudi, also features in the video.

“She was very enthusiastic about singing and

performing,” said Ms. Abisha, and the group decided to use her own voice in the track.

The group worked through multiple drafts over the course of two months and revised the lyrics based on inputs from Poovulagin Nanbargal. Ms. Abisha performs in the video alongside Kavya, who contributes Kannada lyrics in the song, bringing her Bengaluru connection into the track.

The *Climate Emergency Mixtape* is a collaboration between Youth Ki Awaaz, Kraantinari, Asar Social Impact Advisors, Folksoul, and the Climate Culture Collective.

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1	Name of work	RECONSTRUCTION OF R.C.C. SYPHON BARREL FROM CHAINAGE 0.132KM TO CHAINAGE 0.286KM OF LEFT MAIN CANAL UNDER LATRATU RESERVOIR SCHEME.
2	Estimated Cost(Rs)	Rs. 11.77.52,708.61
3	Bid Security (Rs.)	Rs. 11.78.000.00 (Online mode)
4	Cost of Tender Document	Rs. 10,000.00(Online mode)
5	Time of Completion	12(Twelve) Months.
6	Availability of Tender On Line	24.09.2026 From 03:00 PM
7	Bid Submission	From 01.10.2026, 11:00 AM to 07.10.2026 upto 02:00 PM
8	Pre Bid Meeting	29.09.2026, 03:00 PM Chief Engineer, WaterResources Department, Ranchi.
9	Date & Time of Opening Technical Bid	08.10.2026, 04:00 PM
10	Name and address of officinviting tender	Executive Engineer, Waterways Division,Khunti.
11	Contact No. of Procurement Officer	8789034733.
12	Help Line No. e-Procurement	8789754653.

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3. Payment of Mobilization advance / equipment advance shall be applicable as per Joint Secretary, WRD Ranchi Letter No. 656 Dated 22-12-2020.
4. The bidder should be fully acquainted with site before the tender.
5. Authority reserves the right to reject any or all the tender(s) received or to allot the work to one or more contractor(s) without assigning any reason thereof.
6. Estimated Cost May vary. Online BOQ amount shall prevail.
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No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-DPR-05/1596/2026-27 Date: 18.09.2026

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UTILITIES & SERVICES	I, YASHVY JAYARAMAN D/O POORNA SIVAKUMAR aged 4 years Residing at 20/21 B, Vasantham Flats, Gayathri Nagar, Hashinapuram, Chennai – 600064, shall henceforth be known as YASHVY P JAYARAMAN
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ELDER CARE	MADHA MEDICAL COLLEGE & HOSPITAL Kundrathur Main Road, Thandalam, Kovur, Chennai - 600 128 Phone 81480 66666 / 77777 This is to inform the public that we the Madha Medical College & Hospital, we going to destroy the Medical Records of Inpatients for the period of January 2018 to December 2021. Patients who want to have photo copies of the records may contact our Medical records department with supporting documents of copy of discharge summary necessary ID proof with signed application etc., within one month from this notice date. For any clarification please contact Medical Record Dept., of this Hospital M. Murugan, B.A. B.Sc Medical Record Officer Place: Kovur Ph: 9962142512 Date: 18.09.2026 MMCH : 600128
BUYING / SELLING	ALL SOFAS , All Recliners, Recondition, Reupholstery KNS Rajan 7667133233
FURNITURE	AUTISM KIDS Clinic Annangr. Reflex- Sensory Speech Therapy 8610207679
HEALTH	HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Nagar. 60min– 99/- Ct: 90421 82826
HOME SERVICES	MARIAS (REGD) Provides Housemaids, Cooks, Patient Attenders, Little Mount, Ch-15. 22350602/ 9840309975
MEDICAL	MRP RS.2900 , C.T. Rs.900 Ultrasound Rs.500 MHC + Echo Rs.2500 SVDG, In-side DG Vaishnav College Arumbakkam 7824048299/399 7am–7pm Sun Hol

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Toll Free @ 1800 102 4161

REAL ESTATE

INDEX OF REAL ESTATE	SELLING
ARCHITECTS	COMMERCIAL
BUILDER'S REQUISITES	✓ 725 - SqFt Showroom on Arcot Road, next to Porur Metro Station. Contact: 9840972270.
BRICKS/CONCRETE BLOCKS	13.5 GROUNDS Near Madhavaram on GNT Road Ct - 9884395566
BUILDING CONTRACTORS	COMMERCIAL BUILDING
BUILDING MATERIALS	MOUNT ROAD Independent commercial building G+1 floor for sale near LIC. Buyers call 8861118696
CEMENT	OMR, KANDANCHAVADI 36000 & 28000 sqft, IT office space occupied Multi storeyed Building. Sale 9500408278
CONCRETE MIX	PRIME PROPERTY on Rajaji salai Parrys. Standalone Building Approx 10, 000sqft Basement+5 Floors Built on 2044sqft of Land East Facing Genuine Buyers Call: 9869164779/ 7338779689
HARDWARE	T NAGAR Bazulath Road Builtup 3000 sqft Rented at 1.52 Lakhs per month Listed at 3.7 Cr P+ 9384602261
MARBLE	5.5GR 30K Sft New Bld Tenant Reliance Income 30L P/M NoBr 9840045676
PAINTING CONTRACTORS	VALASARAVAKKAM LA , 2400sqft Bk 6200sqft, G+2 Floor 3CCP 7 Cr. 9790828187
CONSULTANTS	COMMERCIAL LAND
HOME DECOR	OMR 6 – 12 Grounds Next to Kelambakkam Call 95000 41400 Buyers Only
PUBLIC NOTICE	Rampapuram on Main Rd, 2Gr, N.E Corner. Ct: 9840063993/ 8778038176.
HOME FINANCE	TAMBARAM WEST - Kishkinta On Main Road, 4000 Sqft Corner CMDA Plot, Rs. 2700/- Per Sqft. Ph: 9551759999
JOINT DEVELOPMENT	1ACRE 20CENT Tirupati Highway Periyapalayam Main Road 150Mtr Inside Nearby Vel Medical College 7200908802
BUYING	VELACHERY MAIN Road Phenix Mall Opp 4260sqft. Call: 9940558874
SELLING	VELACHERY MAIN Road, 1 Ground commercial for sale Ct: 9790704673
<i>Classification common for Buying and Selling</i>	BANGALORE HIWAY Sanguvarachattam Main Road Property 150Acre. 9940558874
COMMERCIAL	GUINDY SIDCO INDL ESTATE NEAR RAILWAY / METRO & BUS STAND 3.5 GROUND INDUSTRIAL COMMERCIAL LAND FOR SALE. EAST FACING, 2 SIDES ROAD SUITABLE FOR OFFICE, IT/IES, FACTORY & LOGISTICS 98416 98803
COMMERCIAL BUILDING	OMR PERUNGUDI Nr.WTC, off OMR 2660sqft 30Ft Rd. 7397475554, 9880770688
COMMERCIAL LAND	ECR NEELAKARAI on Rd 8.5Gr 160ft Front Suit Showroom NoBr 7200033666
FACTORIES & SITES	1.63 ACRES @ Redhills 400 feet road very near Krish International School & DAC Developers Red Fort Villa Plots, Suitable for residential & Commercial 9952749037
FARM HOUSE/ LAND/ RESORTS	NEED 1–6GRDS Around Chennai Main Rd Commercial Develop Land 9840055888
RESIDENTIAL	GENERAL
RESIDENTIAL FLAT-NEW	WANTED 1 to 2 Grounds with or without Building in Selaiyur, Madipakkam, Rajakipakkam, Annanagar, Mugappair Ct: 9884818939 / 9884828939
RESIDENTIAL FLAT-RESALE	REQ COMM space 1000–7000sqft T.Nr. Anna Ngr, Nungambkm, Adyar. 9840675252
RESIDENTIAL HOUSE	COMMERCIAL LAND
RESIDENTIAL LAND	NEED 1–6GRDS Around Chennai Main Rd Commercial Develop Land 9840055888
TIME SHARE	GENERAL
GENERAL	BUYING, COMMERCIAL Office, 500 to 2000 Sq.ft in Alwarpet to Adyar. Budget upto Rs.5 Crores. 1 Car Park. Bysani Property Advisors: 9789000737

BUYING, COMMERCIAL Office, 500 to 2000 Sq.ft in Alwarpet to Adyar. Budget upto Rs.5 Crores. 1 Car Park. Bysani Property Advisors: 9789000737	ECR KOOVATHUR to Pavunjur on Main Rd 22Cents 40L NoBroker. 9662223334
REQ COMM space 1000–7000sqft T.Nr. Anna Ngr, Nungambkm, Adyar. 9840675252	OMR MAHABALIPURAM 1Gr, 2Gr for Sale 40L/Gr No Broker Ct: 9380445555
COMMERCIAL LAND	ECR MUGAIYUR OppSeaside 500mtr Dist.50Cent–1Acre 1.25L/Cent 9944005933
NEED 1–6GRDS Around Chennai Main Rd Commercial Develop Land 9840055888	ECR MARAKANAM BeachEnd Prop. 32Cent, 50Cent–1Acre 2.50L/Cent 9944005933
GENERAL	ECR MUGAIYUR Seaside 15Cent, 30Cent, 60Cent Rs.2.50L/Cent 9944005933
WANTED 1 to 2 Grounds with or without Building in Selaiyur, Madipakkam, Rajakipakkam, Annanagar, Mugappair Ct: 9884818939 / 9884828939	ECR INJAMBAKKAM , VGP layout 3Grd Bungalow for sale. Ct: 99402 14424
REQ NEW / Resale Premium 2 & 3 BHK flat in Harrington & Kilpauk. No brokers. Call: 98410 04201	ECR PATTIPULAM 11.50 Acre Sale Per Acre Rs.3.50Cr Ct: 9940440864
WTD 1/2/3 BHK Flats in&Around Egmore, Kilpauk, Perambur. Ct: 7305825266	50 CENT Panchai, 30rd DTCP Plot Road, Near Madurantakam Ct: 8825477683
RESIDENTIAL LAND	MAHABALIPURAM GATED Cmnty EB Water Line 4.3Gr NF Rs.2200/Gr 9677080055

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RESIDENTIAL FLAT – NEW

T.NAGAR, NR BS Terminus, Ready for occupation, Duplex Flat, 1449 sqft, Triple Bed Room, Rs.14,000/ sqft, Accurate Consultants, Ct: 9585397149, 63813 99195.

KEELKATTALAI & Madipakkam 676 sqft., to 1326 sqft., 2 & 3 bhk BNC Nagappa shelters 9566241333.

PUZUTHIVAKKAM New Customizable 1, 2 BHK Flats 43–L onwards 78100 25909

RAMAPURAM NEW Customizable 2, 3, 4 BHK flats 77–L onwards. 78100 25909

ALWARTHURNAGAR NEW 2, 3 BHK for sale 87–L onwards. Ct: 78100 25909

VALASARAVAKKAM 3BHK Sft+Stirs Ngr EB off Narain Promoters 9444131914

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – NEW	RESIDENTIAL LAND
ARCOT ROAD 3BHK 1664sqft 557UDS 4Toilet NF Gated Comm 1.75Cr 8667421425	WALAJABAD 2 DTCP Plots 600 & 882Sqft Size Rs.900/-per sqft 98842 66966
KK NGR 2/3BHK CCP, Lift,Gym,Terrace Garden, CCTV 1.62Cr. Ph:7094222211	SRIPERUMBUDUR NEAR Valarpuram 1 To 4 Grnd & Near Tiruvallur 5 Acres to 20 Acres.Ct:9840246265 / 9840253183
ALWARTHURNAGAR BOOK Now for Offer Price 2BHK 1050Sqft,Lift ,CCP, Near Metro.SRK CONSTRUCTIONS: 9080397355 / 9840957621	OTTIVAMBAKKAM 920 Stt,West 23 x 40, 50Lac.CMDA Approved.Ct. 9884289243
3BHK ARCOT Road 1664sf 482 Uds 2941 sqft N/F Gated Comm 1.82Cr 9500063091	OMR THORAIPAKAM CMDA App E/F 3000sf 40Ft Rd 4Crs NoBroker. 9622233334
KK NAGAR B New 3BHK 1450Stt 2 Cr 3BHK 1900 Sft 2.30 Cr EA.9940481639	ORAGADAM-KANCHIPURAM RD Mugambki Ngr 7200sf Sts 2500sf/ sqft. 9940098191
MUTTUKADU ECR Brand New Flat 3600Stt Rs.2.70Crs.Ct. 9840245678	VANDHAVASI-DINDIVANAM NH Rd 2Acre 31Cent Sivanasvil. Mr Vandhavasilv. Taluk 25000/Cent Nego Ct. 7904110426
ALWARTHURNAGAR PREMIUM 3BHK Vaasthu CCP Flat for sale Ct:9962099997	THAMARAIPAKKAM TO THIRUVALLUR Road, MELANOUR VILLAGE Gomathi Amman Nagar 10 Plots THIRUVALLUR TO THUKOTTALAI Road, KUNJALAM VILLAGE 120000 Sq.ft, 90 Plots OMR KARUNKUZZHI ALLAM THIRUPURUR 2&5 Acre For SALEs/ MARKETING 8870 590 499, 9380 888 999
KODAMBAKKAM –PREMIUM 3BHK 1508 & 1440 Sqft. Rs.14K Base Price Per sqft.Individual Solar, Smart Automations, Lift up to Terrace, 45KVA Genset(Covers 1 AC), Kid's Play Area, CCTV, Access Entry & many more. Possession Diwali 2026. Ph: 93429 12618	DTCP SRM Opp VGN Potheri Rly Stn 2400 Sqft 40Ft Rs.1.15Crs. Dr: 9526326978
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VADAPALANI / Nanganaluru 2/3BR 1.5C Bmew Pkm 2/3BR TNR 3BR 9962192721	ECR KOVALAM , Nr Olive Beach – 2400, 2300, 811835F @ 1.3Cr/ Grd: 9030011274
TRICHY THILLAI Ngr 3BR 1700sf Sri-ranganth 2/3BR Lift, CCP. 9962192721	ECR SEA side 2400 Sq ft, DTCP & CRZ Approved Plots @ Rs.33.3 LAKHS, Nr. Kovathur, Secured Gated Community & Bank Loan Avl. Ct:7540054006
WEST MAMBALAM – Ganapathi Street, 3BHK 1080 Sqft & 2BHK 877sqft Nearing Completion Lift up to Terrace, CCTV,CCP, Ct: 8668128003	KORATTUR, VAGAI Nagar, Premium, 2200sq.ft. Land, North Facing, Compounded, Clear Title. Ct: 9840043136
MANAPAKKAM: MODERN 4BHK Premium Homes at IPS Colony. Minutes from Trade Centre, MIOT Hospitals, Metro & Airport. Ready for fitout. Starting From Rs. 1.85Cr. Ct: 044-4949445	THAIYUR KOMMAN Ngr 10Grds Dry Land Clear Title Rs 65L/PGrd. 9840245678
10MINS From Adyar Ready to Occupy Premium 2 & 3 BHK Apartments at Perungudi, OMR (Behind World Trade Centre). Special Price Rs. 1.19 Cr Onwards. Ct: 044-49494506	ADAMBARKKAM LAKE View 50ft

Matrimonial

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BRIDEGROOMS WANTED

INDEX OF MATRIMONIAL

BRIDEGROOMS WANTED

BRIDES WANTED

BRIDES & GROOMS WANTED

Classification Common for Brides, Bridegrooms, Brides & Grooms

ASSAMESE

AWADHI

BENGALI

BHOJPURI

BIHARI

CHHATTISGARHI

ENGLISH

GUJARATI

HARYANI

HINDI

KANNADA

KASHMIRI

KONKANI

MALAYALAM

MANIPURI

MARATHI

MARWARI

NEPALI

ORIYA

PARSI

PUNJABI

SAURASHTRA

SINDHI

TAMIL

TELEGU

TULU

URDU

ADVOCATE

BUSINESS

DEFENCE

DOCTOR

ENGINEER

FINANCE/BANKING

GOVERNMENT/QUASI-GOVERNMENT

IAS/ALLIED SERVICES

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

MBA/CA/ICWA

NRI

COSMOPOLITAN

DIVORCEE

PHYSICALLY CHALLENGED

MARRIAGE BUREAUS

WEDDING ARRANGEMENTS

COSMOPOLITAN

MS-QC, AGE 31, working UK. Seeking Groom well-Educated & Job Age 35 preferable Abroad. Ct: 9092962442.

HINDU SC 29yrs Officer TN Govt seeks suitable understanding groom who is not interested in having child 8088613172

HINDU SC AD 26, height 165cm, MA Asst. Prot. Revathi Meenam Chennai. Seeks Govt/MNC Groom. Contact No. 9498313780

DIVORCEE

BEAUTIFUL, KIND 39, 163cm, responsible, well-educated professional. Seeks smart, warm, compatible groom. Caste no bar. Call/Wa 9345 634 365

DOCTOR

25YRS CSI-NADAR Fair MBBS- Ready to NEET- Upper- middle. Seeks a Groom, Doctor or No.1 Officer in Govt. Any Christian ok. Ct: 8610774168

FAIR, CULTURED, Good looking, Slim, Doctor girl, first marriage, 37/165 MD, Cardiac Anesthesiologist, Chennai based affluent Doctor family. Father Keralite Nair, Mother from TN. Looking for Doctor or Engineer groom from respectable family. Ct: 984050381/ 9840985383

MD GENERAL Medicine DM Doctor Girl, 156cm/1992, seeks suitable groom. 9497 168001, 9447 493034.

REMARriage - Syrian Christian doctor 37 years, 163 cms, slim fair, professor

ALLMS North India. Retired parents with liberal religious attitude invite proposals from **Doctors, Engineers, Officers of Central Government Institutes, IITs** and other transferable professionals.

Contact - 9995460529, 9447558971

SC ADIDRAVIDA 27 MBBS Chennai Employed Seeks Grooms Central / State officers/PG Doctors 9443175609

GOVT / QUASI GOVT

Hindu Adi Dravidar 28 Yrs/152 cm/ 52 BE AO, 14 LPA, PSE, Tamil Nadu Contact - Phone: 9600983800

IAS / ALLIED SERVICES

Hindu, Tamil, Gounder, 45 years, IPS, seeks Groom, Contact Phone: 9578822036

MALAYALAM

ALLIANCE INVITED for Hindu Nair bride, 29/162 cm, Ph.D (Physics) scholar, seeks suitable well educated working groom. Ct: 9445691044.

EZHAVA GIRL, 26/152 cm, Aiyilam, B.Tech, IT Engineer, Senior Associate (Alliance), Parents invite suitable alliance. Brokers excuse. Ph: 8590174150.

NAIR DOCTOR Girl DM 32 Yrs 161 Cm seeks Doctor - Professional. Mob: 9249 920550, 8089 584220.

MALAYALI 29YRS Hindu/ Nair (1997) Aiyilam Working at Paris Seeks Hindu Malayali Boys holding Schengen Visa working in EU or UK preferred Ct: 9901929074

TAMIL

CHRISTIAN VANNIYAR BRIDE 31/ 159 cm / Deputy Commercial Tax Officer, B.Tech, 8 LPA, expecting Doctors, Bank Manager, Govt employee from any BC Christian. Ct: 63741 36192.

CHRISTIAN-RC SOZHIA Vellalar, DnB-Radiology, 28yr, Chennai. Seeks Professional Match, RC Groom 9840150090

ROMAN CATHOLIC, Private, looking for a groom from 29-33 from any subcaste, upper middle class/rich family, 813900312.

SOZHIA VELLALAR 28, Tiruvonnam, Market Research Analyst Accenture Sydney, seeks same caste groom in Australia / Far East /UAE. Email biodata/ horoscope: krc46_in@yahoo.com / WhatsApp 9443562127.

RC UDAYAR, Singapore, Looking for a groom from Singapore PR and working visa from 27-32 from any subcaste, 8139009214

BORN AGAIN Christian, looking for a groom from any sub-caste in any country from 30-37, 8137001247

RC, B.Arch, looking for a groom from 26-30 from any subcaste in Tamilnadu, 8138 900575

CATHOLIC, BE, Looking for a groom from 26-31 from Catholic, RC pillar & Nadar from anywhere, 8138900487

HINDU AGAMUDAIYAR DOB 3/4/1994 Poaradam, Dhanusu, B.Tech, M.S.(USA) now India willing to relocate seeks Grooms qualified with good family Ct: 94423 99555, 94441 23278

CSI, LOOKING for a groom from 25-30, Pilot,Business,UK profiles from CSI and Christian Nadar, 8137001366

CHRISTIAN 36, 165/64 working in MNC Executive chennai wanted groom from a literate decent family cont: 9444325317

TAMIL

CHRISTIAN NADAR 25 yrs, M.Sc (UK). Lives in USA for the last 10 yrs. Beautiful, slim bride looking for professional groom from an affluent family from Tamilnadu (Bride will settle in Tamilnadu after marriage). Father working as a President in an Engineering Company in USA. Net worth is about 50 Crs. Contact: 9500124086.

RC CHRISTIAN - 38 Yrs, 175cm, Fair, B.E. M.Tech., Divorcee, No Child, Working in Belgium With Good Salary. Seeks Groom 35+ Years, Well Educated, Tall, Well Employed, Willing to Move to Belgium (Caste No Bar) Contact: 9894086383/ 82

BORN AGAIN Christian, 45yrs/152, MBBS, MD doctor, seeks christian groom, Chennai. Ct - 950018067

BALJUANAI DU 32/BE/167CM Punarposam Nakshatra, Mithuna Rasi, Chennai Settled Seeks Well Settled Family with Clean Habits.Whatsapp 9445215488

SOZHIAVELLALAR PILLAI Age 31 BE (CSE) Working in Pvt Sector Chennai, Seeks Groom Preferable from Pillai/Mudaliyar Age 31-34, BE Working In IT Field Employed in Chennai / India / Abroad. Ct: Gowdhaman 9342276143

SC AD 33 MCA Unmarried Seeking Suitable Groom Ph: 8610410886 Unmarried Certificate must. Brokers Excuse

SC PALLAR, Divorcee, 38, Caste No Bar, B.E, M.S Seeking a Suitable Groom. Call/whatsapp 7539985037.

GROOM WANTED Mudaliyar,31yrs, BE, Rich and Affluent business family in Chennai.Ph: 9952619776

GROOM WANTED Naidu,31yrs, MBBS, MD, Well Educated Family background. Ph: 6385293227

28YR GYNAECOLOGIST Asst.Prof Government, Chennai seek Vegetarian Doctor/professional groom Ct: 8778447714

CSI Christian Bride 36 BE Working in MNC seeks Christian Groom 37 to 40 Yrs BE/ME Working in MNC. Ct:9043019165

DKVISC MAY 94/32, 167cm Fair BE Parents Hindu / CSI, Seeks Groom Dr./Er. / Abroad / Govt. Ct: 8056143638

HASTHAM 38 Fair MCA 1stmarriage Chennai seeks Pillai/Mudaliyar prof working Groom.8220757159/ 8925640261

MUDALIYAR GIRL, MBA, Very Fair, 167cm, 28 years Upper Middle Class working in Government (Outsource). Seeks Mudaliyar Groom from Good Family please Call or WhatsApp to 94445 47499 / 94449 35026

MUDALIAR 25, BE, MS, 163cm Good Looking Well settled Family Seeks Groom CNB.Ct: 8778514465 / 7200866346

VANNIYAKULA KSHATRIYA (27/164cm) LLM, working in Pvt Co, as Deputy Manager,pretty, raghu kethu dosham, seeks suitable groom. Ct: 9940655572

✓ MUDALIAR SC 5.6 working well settled in Chennai seeking qualified Groom from age 32-37 9884863220

MUDALIAR, DOCTOR, M.D (Pathology), 41 yrs, Divorcee, No child, working in a hospital, well settled family, seeks suitable groom preferably doctor or engineer. Caste No Bar. Contact: 8056868090

SC, AD, 32, BE, MBA, Ashwini, Mesham, Chevai Dosham, Only Daughter, Bengaluru, Well Settled Family, Seeks Decent Family, BE, B.Tech, PG, Employed, Groom Chennai, Bengaluru. CNB.Ph:9600932650

CHRISTIAN NADAR, Rich, MBA, looking for equal subcaste from 26-31 from Well educated and settled groom, 8137 001247

SC, UK, Govt. BSC, looking for a groom from any caste from 29-34 USA, UK, Singapore and European countries, 8137 001255.

CASTE No Bar, Rich/affluent, Doctor, looking for a groom from 34-38 from any caste, good looking rich profiles in chennai. 8138900412.

TAMIL

MUDHALIYAR, LLB, MBA, looking for a groom from equal caste from 27-30, lawyer, CA, Business profiles, 8137003516

PILLAI 26Yrs/157cm Pooja Fair BE Hospital Mgt Canada seeks grooms any Country.9894107825, 9500595339

HINDU NADAR Divorce Unconsummated Marriage-35 BE.MBA Accenture UK-London CyberSecurity Associate Manager Seeks Blw 39yr CNB CL/WA 9442126376

AGE 35 BE MBA MS(UK) Divorced unconsummated marriage seeks preferably NRI groom. Caste No bar. 9444298707

GROOMS WANTED

1999 Born Vokkalika Gounder 5'6" MBA, Fair Girl, Only Daughter, Working in PSU (Consultancy). Seeking Tall, Smart & Well Qualified Groom From Elite Family in Chennai Preferably Gounder, Mudhaliyar, or Equivalent Caste Ct: 73050 10105

GROOM WANTED CNB,41yrs, BE, MBA, Elite business family in Chennai. Ph: 6385293227

GROOM WANTED Naidu,29yrs,ME, Elite business family in Chennai.Ph: 9384772710

ADIDRAVIDAR, 26, MBA, looking for any caste groom from Mumbai based (IIM,CAT, MBA), 8138900487

SC, UK, Caste, looking for a UK/Euro-pean grooms from 29-35, 8137003516

UDAYAR, CANADA, M.tech,looking for a canada groom from 27-33 from well educated and settled,8138900312

MUDALIYAR, MBA, MNC, Looking for a well settled groom from 30-35 from Mudaliyar and pillar caste, Contact : 8138 900553

NAICKER, ME, looking for a groom from 29-31 from Naidu and Naicker from Well educated and settled family, 8138009144.

GROOM WANTED Mudaliyar,27yrs, MBBS, MS, Well Educated Family. Ph: 6385293227

SC AD 29/161 M.E. Ph.D (A.U-Guindy) barani Mesham Sevali Dosham seeks well educated groom with strong family values. Contact: 9597340840 / 8056494772

Thuluvu Vellala 28/152 BE MBA MSc seeks teetotaler good family BG employed PG groom SNB ct:8362794549, malaranihs@gmail.com

SEEKING UNMARRIED GRADUATE/IN/NOT-IT PROFESSIONAL for 44yrs unmarried Tamil SC Hindu Adi Dravidar Female IT professional residing in Singapore. Contact +91 7200942776 / +65 91051142.

MUDALIAR GIRL age 20 PUC educated employed in Bangalore Seeks Suitable Boy Contact 9353940454

AGAMUDAYA MUDALIAR 34 Dentist Chennai. Seeks well educated, good family background Groom. Ct: 9486531194

GROOM WANTED SC(Ad),30yrs, MBBS, MD, Elite business family in Chennai.Ph: 6385293227

GROOM WANTED Hindu Nadar 35 yrs, divorce,MBBS,MD, Elite Business Family.Ph: 9380791999, 9841329471

INTERCASTE, 25, Masters, Business, looking for a groom from 26-31 from Mudaliar and Naidu from Kongu and chennai circle, 8137001387.

HINDU SC AD 38 Sr. Software Engineer TCS Chennai Rs 1.40 LPM seeks suitable groom working in Chennai. Ct: 99521 47216 / 88380 34943

MUDALIAR, 27/164, Fair, MS, D Scientist, Meta Bangalore,28LPA, Affluent Family CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

Seeking groom from affluent family for 33/170cm redddy hindu girl employed as technical lead in MNC Bangalore. Only daughter well to do family CNB. 9944949052

REDDY, Divorced, Masters, looking for a 2nd marriage profile from 29-35 from any caste in India and UAE, 8138900312.

VISWAKARMA, MSC, Upper middle class, seeking for a groom from 24-28 from same caste in tamilnadu, 8138900523.

WEDDING ARRANGEMENTS

MARRIAGE HALLS

SHREE HALL A/C T.Nagar Marriage& Other Functions 9444467090/ 9884885282

SRI PADMAVATHY Venkateshwara Hall Ac Mini Hall Ac 100yr trust with free offer Sep Oct Nov few dts available T.Nagar. 7845089089

SRI GAJALAKSHMI KALYANA MANDAPAM / C, Velappan Chavadi, Chennai. Vacant Days February 5th, 18th, 26th 2027. Ct: 9382170924, 9840061297

RAJALAKSHMI KALYANA MANDAPAM, 205/ 1, Velachery Main Rd, Dhan-deeswaram, Velachery, A/C, Full Facility, Ample Carpark. Ph:22435353/ 9840545585

TAMIL

RC, UDAYAR, optometry, looking for a groom from 27-32 from singapore and any christian subcaste, 8137003550

REDDIAR, RAKU/KETU, BDS, looking for a Reddy groom from 28-34 from any location,8137003550

IYENGAR, THIRUVONUM, Kaushiga 32/165 M.Tech/IT working in MNC Bangalore 3 LPM, seeks equally qualified groom settled in Bangalore only. Age diff 1-5. Ct: 99401 46834.

42 years / RC / US / Scientist seek Unmarried Groom Working in US - Contact: 9884079338

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BRIDES WANTED

COSMOPOLITAN

✓ ROMAN CATHOLIC/ Oct 94/ 180 cms/ B.E., M.S

INBRIEF



Naidu distributes pattas to over 28,000 families in A.P.

Ending decades-long wait for ownership rights over lands, Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu on Saturday distributed immersion *pattas*/conveyance deeds to 28,445 families spread across 11 mandals in Visakhapatnam district. The land regularised under the programme, ‘Pedalaku Pattabhishekam’, covers 399 acres (or 19,33,853 square yards), with an estimated registration value of ₹8,874 crore.

Seven killed in two separate road accidents in Hyderabad

Seven people were killed in two separate road accidents on the outskirts of Hyderabad in the early hours of Saturday. In the first accident, four members of a family returning after Ganesh immersion were killed after their vehicle went out of control on NH-44, and crashed into a bridge, the police said. Hours earlier, three workers were killed after a truck rammed their stationary goods vehicle on the Outer Ring Road while they were trying to replace a flat tyre.

KPSC recruitment case: ED takes IAS officer into custody

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has taken IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar and alleged intermediary Basavaraj Kannale into custody for questioning in connection with the probe into alleged irregularities in the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) recruitment. Both the accused are already in judicial custody at the Bengaluru Central Prison. The ED took custody of the two late on Friday night for questioning over suspected financial transactions.

Land acquisition for Warangal airport completed: Revanth

Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy has invited public suggestions for naming the new airport at Mamnoon in Warangal district, as the State government has completed the required land acquisition and handed over the land to the Airports Authority of India. In a social media post, Mr. Reddy said that ₹295 crore had been allocated by the government for the land acquisition.

Will not evict farmers from forest areas: Karnataka CM

His assurance comes in the wake of draft notification to declare regions across Western Ghats as eco-sensitive areas; CM tells forest department not to issue fresh notices to traditional cultivators

Sathish G.T.
TIRTHAHALLI (SHIVAMOGGA)

Responding to pleas to oppose the draft notification proposing to declare regions across the Western Ghats as ecologically sensitive areas (ESAs), Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Saturday said he would stand by the farming community. He directed the Forest Department not to issue eviction notices to traditional cultivators citing forest encroachment. During a public consultation on the K. Kasturirangan report at Tirthahalli, Mr. Shivakumar said he understood the problems faced by the people in the



Seeking relief: A farmer submits a memorandum to Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar at public hearing in Shivamogga on Saturday. PTI

Malnad region. He told the Forest Department not to issue fresh notices to any traditional cultivator, while adding that it should not allow fresh encroachments either. “Let the department protect forests, but the tra-

ditional cultivators should not be disturbed,” he said. The Chief Minister said he could have taken a decision in Bengaluru on the Centre’s draft ESA notification, issued on the basis of the Kasturirangan report. However, he said he chose

to meet people and take their opinions into account.

Farmers seek survey
During the consultation, a few participants suggested a physical survey to identify human habitations and cultivated areas within the proposed ESA. “Some have also suggested a Kerala-model survey to overcome the disadvantages of the Kasturirangan report. We will discuss all these suggestions during the special session on the issue next week. The State government will take an appropriate decision to safeguard the interests of farmers,” the Chief Minister said.

Screening of film on Umar Khalid cancelled

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Law and Society Committee (LawSoc) at the National Law School of India University (NLSIU) has decided to drop the documentary screening on activist Umar Khalid following a discussion with the Student Bar Association and the university administration on Friday evening, students from NLSIU said. A student told *The Hin-*

du, “The Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) recently highlighted that the documentary, *Prisoner No: 626710 is Present*, is not certified. Screening this documentary violates the Cinematograph Act unless a specific exemption has been obtained.” However, the LawSoc committee is holding a discussion series on political prisoners, criminal justice and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

Woman’s body parts found in canal in A.P.

Rajulapudi Srinivas
VIJAYAWADA

In a gruesome incident, a woman was killed and her body parts were dumped in the VTPS cooling canal at Ibrahimpatnam in NTR district of Andhra Pradesh. “The police recovered the torso and limbs from the canal on Saturday, and are searching for other missing parts,” said West Zone Assistant Commissioner of Police N.S.V.K.

Durga Rao. The victim was around 25 years old.

Lens on missing cases
An alert has been sounded in the neighbouring police stations to verify the ‘woman missing’ cases, the Assistant Commissioner said. “Efforts are on to identify the victim. Clues tent and sniffer dogs squads were pressed into service,” Mr. Rao, who visited the scene of the offence, told *The Hindu*.

Court sends Reporter TV MD to excise custody

The Hindu Bureau
KOZHIKODE

The Judicial First Class Magistrate Court I in Wayanad, on Saturday remanded Anto Augustine, managing director of Reporter TV, in the custody of

the Excise Department for a day. The legal proceedings stem from an investigation initiated under the Kerala Abkari Act. On Thursday, excise officers conducted searches at Mr. Augustine’s ancestral residence in

Wayanad, and seized over 60 litres of alcohol, an amount exceeding the statutory permissible limit for personal possession. While the Excise Department had initially sought a four-day custody period to trace the origin

of the contraband, the court sanctioned a 24-hour period expiring at 12 p.m. on Sunday. Investigators suspect potential procurement links to the neighbouring Union Territory of Mahe, a hub for low-duty liquor.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday

TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Sunday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Kerala and Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, West Bengal, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Konkan & Goa

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	0.2.....	35.2	25.7	Kurnool		37.3.....	27.1
Ahmedabad	24.8.....	33.1	24.4	Lucknow		31.6.....	26.4
Aizawl		33.7	24.0	Madurai		38.0.....	26.2
Bengaluru	0.3.....	31.2	22.1	Mangaluru		32.5.....	25.2
Bhopal	12.....	31.0	22.6	Mumbai	23.8.....	31.5.....	25.0
Bhubaneswar		35.2	26.0	Mysuru		33.8.....	20.0
Chandigarh		35.0	20.9	New Delhi		35.3.....	25.5
Chennai		36.3	27.2	Patna		33.6.....	27.2
Coimbatore		33.6	23.6	Port Blair	57.9.....	30.6.....	24.7
Dehradun		32.8	20.3	Prayagraj		35.2.....	26.0
Gangtok	9.2.....	24.7	16.7	Puducherry	4.....	36.1.....	23.0
Goa	0.2.....	33.0	25.0	Pune		32.5.....	24.8
Guwahati		35.1	24.5	Raipur	12.....	34.0.....	23.7
Hubballi		31.0	21.0	Ranchi		32.4.....	22.0
Hyderabad		32.9	24.1	Shillong		27.3.....	16.3
Imphal		32.7	21.2	Shimla		26.0.....	17.0
Jaipur		33.6	24.1	Srinagar		27.5.....	10.5
Kochi		31.2	25.6	Thiruvananthapuram		33.4.....	25.7
Kohima		27.0	19.0	Tiruchirappalli		37.5.....	27.4
Kolkata	0.8.....	35.0	26.8	Vijayawada		36.4.....	26.8
Kozhikode		34.4	26.7	Visakhapatnam		34.4.....	27.0

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		51	26	40		91	106
Bengaluru		17		64		77	133
Chennai		7		10	25	26	63
Delhi		13	57	47		106	174
Hyderabad		12	21	24		51	57
Kolkata		15	20	22		99	108
Mumbai		11	9	38		93	74
Pune		7	49	25	24		33
Visakhapatnam		10	62	11		50	108

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Classifieds

LIFE MADE SIMPLE

THE HINDU

RENTAL

INDEX OF RENTAL

ACCOMMODATION WANTED

ACCOMMODATION WANTED-COMMERCIAL

ACCOMMODATION WANTED-RESIDENTIAL

COMMERCIAL

FACTORIES & SITES

FARM HOUSE/LAND/ RESORTS

GUEST HOUSE

HOSTEL

PAYING GUEST

ACCOMMODATION

RESIDENTIAL

TIMESHARE

GENERAL

ACCOMMODATION WANTED – COMMERCIAL

REQUIRED ON RENT

1) INDUSTRIAL SHED/ FACTORY BUILDING

25000-30000 Sqft Industrial shed / Factory building nearby

Ambattur industrial estate / Madhavaram / Chrompet area suitable for garment industry. Reachable by 40 feet container lorry and one loading bay / area.

2) STORAGE FACILITY

5000 Sq.ft for storage purpose

Shed or ground floor facility required in Ambattur Industrial area.

99446 12933 / 87545 40149.

ACCOMMODATION WANTED – COMMERCIAL

ATM SPACE AVAILABLE FOR BANKS

Opposite Egmore Museum, Pantheon Road, Egmore.

9003156473

T.NAGAR SOUTH Boag Rd Indpt Bldg 6000Sft G+2 Vastu N/E Corner,False Ceiling, 6 Air-Con, 3 Car Parking, Rent 5 Lakhs.738779689/9869164779

TNGR USMAN Rd Nr 7500Sft Ind House Arumbakam 1000 & 2000Sft 7667999196

MUGAPPAIR next to Spartan School, Newly Constructed 3000 sqft Commercial Space with Exclusive lift & Car Park for Rent.

98848 90077, 75500 93986

2400 SQFT Space for warehouse, Industrial, Mahindra World City Anjur Village. Cont: 98400 54603

BESANT NGR 8000Sft Beachfront.Com. Ideal for High-End Resto Bar/ Restaurant/Cafe. 9940697989/ 9444728899

IYYAPPANTHANGAL INDEPENDENT 950Sft 2nd Flr. Rent for Office/ Commercial/ Godown. 9940331077, 944387655

IYYAPPANTHANGAL ON Oil Mill Rd 400Sft 1st Flr. Rent for Office/ Commercial/ Godown 9940331077, 9444387655

COMMERCIAL SPACE for rent. Vanagaram – Ambattur Main Road (next to Apollo Hospital). Carpet area 2500 Sq.Ft (GF), 5000 Sq.Ft (FF). Contact: 9840874477 / 7299197759

AMBATTUR, MTH Road, Opp Steadford Hospital Build to Suit Commercial Building in 8000 Sqft Land, 70Ft Frontage. Ct: 9443386864 / 7305874444

RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

NUNGAMBAKKAM 1000SQFT Commercial Property for Rent. Contact 9884324366

5000SFT RCC Bld 14Ft Ht 28/ft withinChennai limit(Kosapur) 9840701871

T.NAGAR RAMAN st 1st floor apartment 1850 sqft 3BH office space rent:90000 per month ct:9444022066

VALASARWAKKAM NR Arcot Rd Next to Central Bank 1000sqft GF–Shop/ Office/ Bank.Ct: 9952964048

VANAGRAM - NOOMBAL 17000 sft FROM - OCT 1ST MODERN WAREHOUSE NO INT COLUMNS DECK HEIGHT 4 FEET 3 BAYS 98402 57114

ADYAR LB Road 2nd Flr 1500Sft Commercial Space for Rent. Ct:7358543993

TNAGAR FURN 2000Sft GF 20W Stn, Full Furn Vastu for Office 9841825935

COMMERCIAL SPACE FOR RENT - KODUNGAIYUR 1100 Sq.Ft, 1st Floor, Suitable for Bank / IT / Micro Finance / All Commercial Office Purpose. Good Ventilation, EB & Water Facility. Rent Rs. 70,000/- Negotiable. Cont: Owner - 98413 64048

Commercial TNHB appd space 491st Gf Anna nagar West Extn.7305958088

ROYAPETTAH HIGH Rd Office Space 1040 sft 2nd Floor Lift Ct: 7338919548

WAREHOUSE GODOWN for Rent 11000 sft. (In 1st floor, RCC Building, parking,lift available. Owner Vivek. Ct: 9342987334.

VELACHERY COMMERCIAL Rental 10000, 9300, 8800,5000sf Rent 9176700075

SHED BUILDING @ Velachery, Opp. Westin Hotel, Behind Vasantha Bhavan 8000sq.ft Parking & Power. 9884049882

1500 SFT Fully Furn Plug&Play IT Space NR Cathedral Rd 45K. 9381280808

NR HYUNDAI Glovis, Papparambakkam 5500sf. New Godown– Rent. 9940057416

SRIPERUMBUDUR NEARBY VALARUPURAM Industrial/Warehouse 1.62Acres Land, Shed Builtup 44000sf Ct: 9940095075

FACTORIES & SITES

PERIYARPATTHAI INDP House 2BHK – Grd.Flr / 2nd Flr 1300sf CP 9841229570

EGMORE

CREEBROS ATLANTIC 1414St, 3BHK, 2Bath, 2COP, 1.2L .No Brks. 8015182893

ANNA NAGAR WEST

Ground Floor Independent Bungalow 3200sf 3 BHK-1COP- Serv Toilett nr SBOA CBSE School. Ph: 7708832395

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CM

Congress candidate sent to judicial custody till Oct. 3

With Nandigram bypoll scheduled for Oct. 6, Pradhan will have little time to campaign; Congress leaders protest as Bengal police defend the arrest as a 'lawful step'; Rahul calls it 'political revenge'

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

A court in West Bengal on Saturday re-manded the Congress's Nandigram byelection candidate, Milan Pradhan, in judicial custody till October 3, leaving him with little time to campaign for the October 6 bypoll.

Mr. Pradhan was arrested on Friday in connection with cases registered against him 19 years ago. The police action came within an hour of former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee extending support to him after her party's candidate, Sanchita Pradhan (De), withdrew her nomination for the byelection.

Congress leaders and workers on Saturday staged a protest march in Kolkata against the arrest of Mr. Pradhan.

The West Bengal Police, in a statement, said the arrest was a lawful step. "Milan Pradhan was arrested in four cases dating back to



Show of support: Congress workers take out a protest rally against Milan Pradhan's arrest, in Kolkata on Saturday. PTI

2007 during the Nandigram protests. Some of the charges include murder, attempt to murder, abduction with intent to murder, causing disappearance of evidence, house trespass, rioting with arms and deadly weapons," the police said. "Execution of long-pending non-bailable warrants is a standing instruction of the Election Commission of India in respect of all elections/bye-elections. The arrest of Shri Pradhan is a lawful step towards compliance with the same during the course of an ongoing special drive," they said.

The police added that

Mr. Pradhan had been absconding and evading due process of law for almost 19 years.

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi described the developments as "political revenge and murder of democracy". "The BJP has no faith in fair elections — that's why it wants to cling to power sometimes through vote theft, sometimes through stealing governments, and sometimes through stealing parties. They don't want to contest elections; they want to end the electoral fight altogether," Mr. Gandhi said in a social media post.

"Some old cases from the Nandigram protests were still open. Once the new government came, they closed all the cases against their own names, but kept those against Opposition parties open to target us like this," senior Congress leader Suman Roy Choudhuri told *The Hindu*.

"The police could have called him. He had declared everything in his nomination papers, so there was no attempt to conceal anything. Everyone knows that a false case was registered in 2007," State Congress president Subhankar Sarkar said.

He added that such cases during the Nandigram protests were filed against many people across party lines. "To the people of Nandigram, I say, you may not be able to see Milan Pradhan now, but keep him in your hearts and each one of you become a Milan Pradhan and fight this," Mr. Sarkar said at the protest march.

In quick U-turn, Mamata's Rejinagar candidate back in race after declaring exit

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Adding to the political uncertainty in West Bengal, Rabiul Alam Chowdhury, the candidate of the Trinamool Congress faction led by former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, on Saturday announced his withdrawal from the Rejinagar Assembly byelection, only to retract his statement less than two hours later.

He said that he had changed his mind and decided to take part in the October 6 byelection as per Ms. Banerjee's wishes.

'Difficult motivation' Earlier, speaking to media-persons in Murshidabad, Mr. Chowdhury said he was finding it difficult to motivate grassroots workers, who have been facing regular harassment, and was considering withdrawing from the contest.

He added that the new symbol allotted by the Election Commission would prove to be a challenge for the party in the byelection.



Rabiul Alam Chowdhury

The Election Commission has allotted the 'footballer' symbol to Ms. Banerjee's faction of the Trinamool and has assigned it the name 'Mamata All India Trinamool Congress'.

Hours later, Mr. Chowdhury said he was asked by Ms. Banerjee not to withdraw from the contest.

Directions and security "I will be contesting the bypoll. We are in *Didi's* party and we cannot do anything outside her wishes. So, following *Didi's* instructions, I am retaining my candidature," Mr. Chowdhury said.

The former Trinamool MLA said that he had been assured of security by the police after Ms. Banerjee

intervened. "Even if only 10 workers stand by me, I will take them along and begin door-to-door campaigning," he added.

New symbols Meanwhile, the freezing of the symbol and name of the All India Trinamool Congress has led to unexpected circumstances with the Indian Secular Front (ISF) turning out to be an unlikely loser.

The rival faction led by Ritabrata Banerjee has been awarded the name 'Democratic Trinamool Congress' and the symbol of 'envelope'.

The ISF had been awarded the 'envelope' symbol for the West Bengal Assembly election held earlier this year. With the rebel Trinamool faction now getting the symbol, the ISF candidates have been assigned the 'cupboard' symbol.

The byelections in the Rejinagar and Nandigram constituencies in the State are scheduled to be held on October 6.

The counting of votes will be held on October 9.

Mamata in SC over EC freeze on Trinamool party symbol

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Trinamool Congress faction led by former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee moved the Supreme Court on Friday against the Election Commission's (EC) decision to freeze the party's symbol.

The petition was filed hours after the poll body on Friday allotted new names and symbols to the two factions led by Mamata Banerjee and Ritabrata Banerjee. On Thursday, the EC had issued an interim order barring the use of the party symbol and name in the Assembly bypolls in Nandigram and Rejinagar in West Bengal.

The plea said the EC did not comprehensively look into the party structure while considering rival claims. It said the EC had banked on the statements of rebel legislators who were facing disqualification proceedings.

The Mamata camp has also filed a separate plea over the delay in disqualification proceedings pending before Assembly Speaker against 10 legislators from the rebel faction.

'BJP trying to intimidate the marginalised through force'

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

Samajwadi Party (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav on Saturday accused the BJP, which heads the governments both at the Centre and Uttar Pradesh, of threatening marginalised groups through force and coercive tactics. The remarks came a day after party MP Pappu Nishad's vehicle was allegedly damaged in a stone-throwing incident during a Ganesh idol procession.

"By targeting leaders and public representatives of the Lodhi community and the Nishad community, the BJP and the government are trying to intimidate the PDA [*picchde* (backward classes), Dalits and *alpsankhyak* (minorities)] society by force", Mr. Yadav said on X.

System run by Modi prefers 'blind followers' over students who ask questions, says Rahul

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The "system" running the country does not want students as they raise questions; instead, it wants only *andhbhakt*s (blind followers), Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said in an address to students in Indore on Saturday. The Congress refers to staunch BJP followers as *andhbhakt*s.

Speaking at the fifth *Chhatron Ki Goonj* student interaction programme, Mr. Gandhi alleged that a "system" had captured the country and it was against students and the education system.

He said the alleged "system" was being controlled by a handful of powerful people, but students posed a danger to it.

Mr. Gandhi said he had held the *Chhatron Ki Goonj*



Political outreach: Rahul Gandhi addresses the fifth *Chhatron Ki Goonj* programme in Indore, Madhya Pradesh, on Saturday. PTI

event in cities like Kota, Pune, Dehradun and Prayagraj, raising students' issues such as paper leak, institutional failure, infrastructural collapse and privatisation.

'System's many layers' "In Indore, we decided to talk about the 'system' versus students," he said, addressing thousands of youth at the IDA ground. "The system has various

layers. At the top, there are six people. It is run by [Prime Minister] Narendra Modi. The tasks of threatening, beating up students with nail studded baton and pellet guns is done by [Union Home Minister] Amit Shahji; he is the enforcer," Mr. Gandhi said, displaying pictures of several BJP and RSS leaders, top bureaucrats, industrialists, and media and film personalities.

The top layer of the alleged system, he said, included Mr. Modi, Mr. Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, National Security Adviser Ajit Doval, and industrialists Gautam Adani and Mukesh Ambani.

Mr. Gandhi further said that students posed a danger to the "system" as they questioned why institutions like judiciary, bureaucracy and the Election Commission "are not doing their jobs properly".

"This is why the 'system' does not want students. It wants *andhbhakt*s who are anti-students. It prepares and promotes *andhbhakt*s. While students are curious, the *andhbhakt*s are delusional and live in their own world... While students are humble and listen to others, the *andhbhakt*s are filled with arrogance. While students are fear-

less, *andhbhakt*s are co-wards. While students respect women, the *andhbhakt*s are patriarchal and attack women..." he said.

During the event, participants raised issues faced in Madhya Pradesh, including delayed recruitment to government jobs, holding of vacancies due to the *sub-judice* OBC reservation hike case and delay in holding nursing exams.

The family of Arpit Jai, an 18-year-old student from Dewas who died in the Delhi building collapse earlier this month, also met Mr. Gandhi on the stage and alleged that their son had died due to the "system's failure".

While concluding his address, Mr. Gandhi said students were the future of India. "We want an India of students, not of *andhbhakt*s," he asserted.

Chirag Paswan to begin youth outreach campaign this month

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Union Minister and Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) leader Chirag Paswan will launch a Gen Z outreach campaign called *Youth Bole To* later this month, with party insiders describing it as an attempt to counter Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's ongoing *Chhatron Ki Goonj* events, in which the Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha raises issues pertaining to the youth.

Mr. Paswan's campaign will begin in Patna on Sep-

tember 24, party's Bihar unit president, Surendra Vivek, announced on Saturday. "...At this event, Chirag Paswanji will engage in direct dialogue with the new generation of Bihar, particularly Gen Z," Mr. Vivek said.

Party insiders said Mr. Paswan is trying to make an impact in the 2027 Assembly polls in Uttar Pradesh, where his party has decided to contest all 403 seats. After Patna, the campaign heads to Uttar Pradesh, with the next event set to be held in Prayagraj on September 27.

ABVP's DUSU win shows youth back 'Nation First' politics: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad's (ABVP) victory in the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections on Saturday drew congratulatory messages from many senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leaders, with Union Home Minister Amit Shah and party president Nitin Nabin describing the result as a mandate from the youth for "Nation First" politics.

In a post on X, Mr. Shah said: "Delhi University is not just a university; students come here to study from every corner of the country. The mandate of this place is a reflection of the sentiments of the youth across India. Today's splendid victory for @ABVPvoice is a clear message to those anti-national forces who want to turn the youth power into a laboratory for their anti-national agenda."



ABVP candidates celebrate after winning the DUSU elections, by the Swami Vivekananda statue at Delhi University. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The ABVP, an affiliate of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), won three of the four central panel posts of DUSU, while Independent candidate Deepanshu Shokeen, who was denied an NSUI ticket, won the vice-president's post. The ABVP won the posts of president, secretary, and joint secretary.

"The youth of the country today stand firmly with the ideology of Nation First, and this is the biggest message of this mandate," Mr. Shah said.

Mr. Nabin said the ABVP's victory reflected the youth's continued faith in positive and constructive student politics inspired by the spirit of 'Nation First' and their commitment to building a "Viksit Bharat".

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh also congratulated the ABVP, expressing confidence that it would continue to work with the "same dedication and commitment to student interests, national service, and nation-building".



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
HE-SCH-PLAN-0037-2026/50242 /IHE., Bhubaneswar, Dated: 18/09/2026

Corrigendum-I

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR RAVENSHAW UNIVERSITY, KATAKA UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BHUBANESWAR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.

RFP No. PM-USHA/03/2026 Date: 31.08.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl. No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Now Modified Provisions
1		4	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 22/09/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 07/10/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		4	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 24/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 08/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA / PM-USHA
11001/325/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0057



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokaseva Bhavan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
Phone: 0674-2954600 | Website: <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in> | Mail : rusa.odisha@gmail.com

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Higher Education Department invites sealed tenders from eligible bidders for the following work :

The complete set of bidding documents and other details are available at <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in>.

EMD : ₹ 10,00,000/-

Last date for receiving of bids: 05.10.2026 up to 5:30 PM
Opening of technical bids: 06.10.2026 at 3:30 PM

Sl.No.	Name of the Work	Tender No.	Tender Fee
1.	Selection of a Consulting firm/ entity for establishment of State Technical Support Group (STSG) for supporting implementation of Pradhan Mantri Uchchatar Shiksha Abhiyan (PM-USHA) in Higher Education Department, Government of Odisha.	PM-USHA : 05 / 2026	₹ 10,000/- + Applicable GST

Bids must be sent via Speed/Registered Post only to :
Joint Secretary to Govt.-cum-SPD (RUSA/PM-USHA), Higher Education Deptt., Lokaseva Bhavan, Bhubaneswar-751001.

Sd/-
Joint Secretary-cum-SPD (PM-USHA)
11001/324/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0056



Government of Odisha - "e" **PROCUREMENT NOTICE**
WORKS DEPARTMENT
E-mail: ceroads.bbsr@gmail.com

RFP Identification No. CE-Roads-II-02/2026-27

- The Chief Engineer, Roads-II, Odisha (Authority) on behalf of the Works Department, Govt. of Odisha is engaged in the Development of State Roads and Highways in Odisha, and, as part of this endeavour, Govt. of Odisha has decided to undertake the following "Projects" under EPC Contract (Engineering, Procurement and Construction) basis, and has decided to carry out the bid process for selection of the parties/Joint Ventures to whom the Project may be awarded eventually.
- Nature of project : Road work
- No. of project : 1 No.
- Tender Paper cost : Rs.10,000.00
- Available of bid document : From 10.00 A.M. of 23.09.2026 to 5.30 P.M. of 30.10.2026
- Date of Pre-Application conference : 12.10.2026 at 12.30 P.M.
- Date of opening of Bid : Dt.31.10.2026 at 11.30 A.M.
- The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: <https://tenderodisha.gov.in> . Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.

Chief Engineer (Roads-II), Odisha
OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL-CUM-ROADS), ODISHA, BHUBANESWAR
34001/810/2627 OIPR-34001/34179/1/26-27/0005



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokaseva Bhavan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
Phone: 0674-2954600 / 7894709964 | Website: <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in> | Mail : rusa.odisha@gmail.com

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Higher Education Department invites sealed tenders from eligible bidders for the following work :

The complete set of bidding documents and other details are available at <https://dhe.odisha.gov.in>.

EMD ₹ 5,00,000/-

Last date for submission of bids: 09/10/2026 up to 4:00 PM
Opening of technical bids: 13/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

Sr.No.	Name of the Work	Tender No.	Tender Fee
1.	Procurement, Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Laboratory Equipment & its accessories for 5 State Public Universities under Regional Directorate of Education, Sambalpur approved under PM-USHA.	PM-USHA : 06 / 2026	₹ 10,000/- + Applicable GST

Bids must be sent via Speed/Registered Post only to :
Joint Secretary to Govt.-cum-SPD (RUSA/PM-USHA), Higher Education Deptt., Lokaseva Bhavan, Bhubaneswar-751001.

Sd/-
Joint Secretary-cum-SPD (PM-USHA)
11001/322/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0055

AI prices are falling but firms are spending more

Growing use of open-weight models is changing the economics; instead of relying entirely on a frontier model, firms can use different models for different tasks.; smaller or open-weight models can handle some workloads at a lower cost while more expensive frontier models can be used for tasks that require greater capability; cheaper tokens are encouraging widespread usage of AI

EXPLAINER

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

Artificial intelligence (AI) is turning sharply cheaper to run on a per-token basis but the amount firms are spending on the same is rising as they move from experiments and chatbots to more complex, multi-step applications.

At a briefing, Coforge management said over the previous seven months, the unit cost of tokens to deliver the same level of AI had fallen about 100-fold while token consumption surged about 8,000-fold.

Coforge also said open-weight models accounted for about 35% of token use on the platforms it was observing compared with about 11-12% in early 2025.

There are broadly two

types of models. Closed or proprietary models such as OpenAI's GPT, Anthropic's Claude and Google's Gemini, keep trained parameters under the developer's control and are typically accessed through a hosted service or API.

Open-weight models such as Meta's Llama make trained parameters available for organisations to download and run themselves subject to the model's licence. Open-weight need not necessarily mean fully open-source. Their training data, training process and other components may be undisclosed.

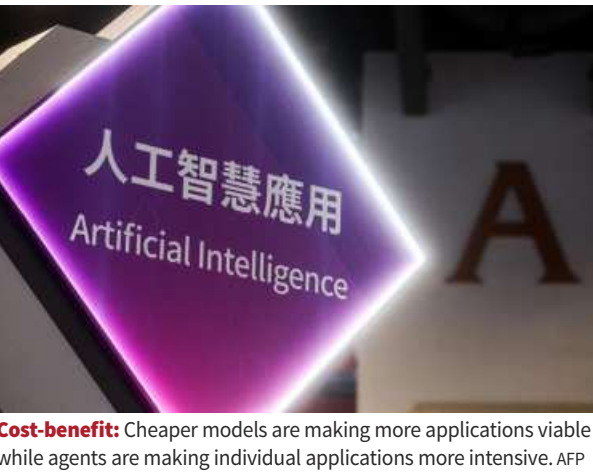
Coforge also said the right way to assess AI economics was "cost per unit task" viz. the cost incurred to finish a defined piece of work and value it creates.

Turning cheaper? Stanford's 2025 AI Index, an annual report tracking

major developments and trends in AI, found the cost of querying a model with GPT-3.5-level performance on a standard AI knowledge and reasoning benchmark fell from \$20 per million tokens in November 2022 to \$0.07 per million tokens by October 2024, a reduction of more than 280 times in about 18 months. Drawing on an analysis by Epoch AI, it found LLM inference prices had fallen between nine and 900 times per year depending on the task.

The OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development) found a similar trend and said its July analysis estimated quality-adjusted prices for text-to-text AI models fell by almost 80% between January 2024 and April 2026.

The nature of the work being given to AI is also changing . A chatbot might



Cost-benefit: Cheaper models are making more applications viable while agents are making individual applications more intensive. AFP

receive a question, process it and return an answer. An AI agent can break a task into several steps, reason, call external tools/systems, inspect the results, revise approach and continue till the task is done. Each additional step can involve more model calls/tokens.

The OECD notes AI agents consume substantially more tokens per task

and can raise model-use intensity by order of magnitude. As a result, falling prices/token do not translate into lower costs for complex AI applications.

Gartner described this as the "Inference Paradox". Its August 2026 analysis says routing a task to an agentic reasoning model can increase provider inference costs by at least

five times compared with a basic chatbot interaction, and often by much more as complexity rises. Gartner sees inference cost per agentic workflow to rise over fivefold through 2028.

Changing the equation

A 2026 working paper by researchers from the University of Michigan, Stanford University, All Hands AI, Google DeepMind, Microsoft AI and MIT found agentic coding tasks consumed about 1,000 times more tokens than the code-reasoning and code-chat tasks used for comparison. It also found runs of the same task could differ by as much as 30 times in total token consumption.

This is showing up in enterprise spending, McKinsey's May 2026 Enterprise AI FinOps survey, covering 75 respondents across five industries, found 93% reported exceeding AI bud-

gets. McKinsey also cited Menlo Ventures data showing enterprise spending on large language models roughly tripled over the 12 months to the end of 2025.

The growing use of open-weight models is changing the economics. Instead of relying entirely on a frontier model, firms can use different models for different tasks. Smaller or open-weight models can handle some workloads at lower cost while more expensive frontier models can be used for tasks that require greater capability.

Coforge said its clients were increasingly moving towards a mix of models. It also identified seven billion tokens of consumption as a "tipping point" in its experience at which clients start considering whether to consume and operate more of the AI stack themselves rather than simply subscribe to a frontier mo-

del. It said that threshold could fall as open-weight and sovereign AI develop further. OECD research, also shows competition and alternative models contributed to falling AI prices.

Measuring AI costs

For firms, a useful measure is economics of the complete task like model calls, tokens, computing resources and human oversight needed to produce a result set against the value of that result.

Gartner's research also points towards measuring token use against business value and economics of the overall workflow rather than treating token prices as proxy for AI. The result is a rapidly changing cost structure, like cheaper models are making more applications viable while agents are making individual applications more computationally intensive.

NTPC drops ₹413 cr. BESS deal as contractor fails on obligations

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

State-owned power producer NTPC Ltd. said it terminated the contract awarded to GR Infraprojects Ltd. (GRIL) for building the 400 Megawatt-hour (MWh) battery energy storage system (BESS) project at its Mouda Super Ther-

mal Power Station (Maharashtra) with immediate effect citing the latter's inability to meet contractual obligations and meet required project progress.

The project - with a contract value of ₹413.37 crore - awarded in March- was scheduled to be completed in 15 months. Explaining the cause for terminating

the contract, NTPC stated, "The project witnessed significant delay in critical activities. A contractual notice was issued to GRIL calling for immediate corrective action, but GRIL failed to undertake the required remedial measures." NTPC added it en-cashed about ₹91 crore from bank guarantees.

MSEDCL uses AI, ML to detect power theft

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Maharashtra State Electricity Distribution Company Ltd. (MSEDCL) said it cracked down on power theft across the State by leveraging Artificial Intelligence (AI) 'Super Intelligence' module.

Combining state-wide

physical inspections by 190 "flying squads" with AI-driven predictive analysis, MSEDCL said it exposed 27,964 instances of power theft worth ₹66.28 crore in 3 months. Criminal cases were registered in 289 instances. MSEDCL said it adopted AI and Machine Learning (ML) to predict power theft accurately.

FinMin, bank CEOs meet

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Finance Ministry has called for a meeting of CEOs of public sector banks and regional rural banks on Monday on steps to ensure continuity of banking operations and essential customer services during the 3-day strike of the United Forum of Bank Unions from September 28.

Hormuz: EIL, Saudi, UAE mull oil infra

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

State-run Engineers India Ltd (EIL) is in early-stage talks with Saudi Arabia and the UAE to provide consultancy and engineering services for oil and gas infrastructure aimed at reducing the Gulf producers' dependence on the Strait of Hor-

muz, severely disrupted by the Iran conflict.

Saudi Arabia and the UAE are planning about \$1 billion spend on pipelines, storage units, oil terminals and infrastructure to provide alternative routes for moving crude and petroleum products to international markets, CMD Atul Gupta told reporters.

CWC chief flags 'malpractices' in phytosanitary tag

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

Central Warehousing Corporation (CWC) MD Santosh Sinha raised concerns over what he described as "malpractices" in phytosanitary certification at ports while declining to name the entities involved.

Speaking to reporters on the sidelines of an event, Mr. Sinha was asked about his reference to malpractices in certification.

He said there had been "a certain result which was not to our liking" but did not elaborate on the incident or identify any port, agency or official.

Mr. Sinha raised the issue while explaining CWC's plans to expand its role beyond conventional warehousing and into integrated logistics for agricultural exports. He cited the rejection of Indian rice at Chinese ports and mango exports by Japan as examples of the challenges Indian exporters could face when consignments fail to meet norms in destination markets.

Asked how CWC could address the issue, Mr. Sinha said: "We have the technical expertise with us."

He said CWC was also upgrading its technical expertise, pointing to his experience in preserving food commodities. CWC currently stores about 50-60 lakh tonne foodgrains and, according to Mr. Sinha, less than 0.5% is lost during storage.

Phytosanitary norms

Mr. Sinha said the issue of export rejection was closely linked to phytosanitary requirements.



Santosh Sinha

He said India would encounter more such challenges as exports rise under free trade agreements.

"This is actually the sign of a growing economy. Because you are now going in for free trade agreements, you will start exporting, you will encounter challenges, you will have to meet them," he said.

In his address, Mr. Sinha said CWC could add a layer of phytosanitary treatment and preservation to the export supply chain to help ensure agricultural produce was not rejected at destination ports.

CWC is seeking to expand its role in agricultural logistics by bringing together storage, preservation, grading, sorting, treatment, cold storage and transportation with connectivity to ports.

CWC was targeting capital expenditure of about ₹1,000 crore this year, similar to the previous year, Mr. Sinha said.

Parallely, CWC was planning its first hyperloop freight trial at its CFS Logistics Park at JNPT, Mumbai, with a ₹23-crore order placed with IIT Madras-incubated TuTr Hyperloop.



The Kerala Minerals & Metals Ltd
(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking) Sankaranamangalam, Kollam-691583
Phone : +91-476-2651215 to 217, E-mail : md@kmmml.com

TENDER NOTICE
For more details, please visit E- Tendering Portal <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> or www.kmmml.com

No	Tender ID	Items
1.	2026_KMML_870878_1	Supply of Valve Control Butterfly 10"

Chavara, 19.09.2026 Sd/, Managing Director for The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd



TELANGANA STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LIMITED
(A State Govt. Undertaking)
Regd. Office :B-3-555/1/A,C.S Bhavan,Somajiguda,Hyderabad-500082

GLOBAL e-AUCTION NOTIFICATION
No.Proc.P2/1413/Rabi 2025-26/Auction paddy Dt:19.09.2026
Telangana State Civil Supplies Corporation Ltd. invites bids for sale of 11.72 LMTs of Rabi 2025-26 Coarse variety paddy (Doddu rakam) stored in Rice Mills and intermediary godowns located in various districts of the Telangana State through e-auction conducted by NEMIL, E-tech innovative solutions, Mjunction and e-auction (Telangana). The Pre-bid meeting is on 22.09.2026 at 2.30 P.M. at Civil Supplies Bhavan, Somajiguda, Hyderabad. The date of e-auction is 28.09.2026 at 12.00 P.M.
For Further details please visit website <https://tender.telangana.gov.in>, <https://market.nemil.in>, <https://www.e-krishnamandi.com> and <https://agro.mjunction.in>.
contact No: 9281423636 Sd/ -
DIPR R.O.No.555-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:19.09.2026 VC & MANAGING DIRECTOR

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PWD CIRCLE KOTA
No. 2145 Date:- 15/9/2026

Notice Inviting Bid (NIT No. 15/2026-27)
Bid for Construction of Various Road work in Distt. Kota is Invited from interested bidders up to 06:00 PM of 30-09-2026 (Wednesday). Other Particulars of the bids may be visited on the procurement portal (<https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rj.nic.in>) of the Rajasthan State.
The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 2194.38Lacs
UBN No. (PWD2627WSOB12138), (PWD2627WSOB12144), (PWD2627WSOB12147), (PWD2627WSOB12151), (PWD2627WSOB12152), (PWD2627WSOB12153), (PWD2627WSOB12154), (PWD2627WSOB12155), (PWD2627WSOB12156), (PWD2627WSOB12157), (PWD2627WSOB12158), (PWD2627WSOB12159)
Superintending Engineer P.W.D. Circle Kota
DIPR/C/16091/2026

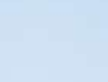


BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer Co-ordination & Planning, 4th Floor, Jayanagara Old Shopping Complex, Jayanagara 4th block, Bengaluru-560011
No: EE(COP)/BSCC/Kppp/TN- 08/2026-27 Date:19-09-2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (IFT) (Two Cover System)
(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
The Executive Engineer, Co-ordination & Planning, Zone-1, BSCC invites tenders on behalf of the Commissioner, BSCC Bengaluru from eligible Tenderers for the Services detailed in the table below.

Sl No.	Name of the works
1	Additional Developments works to Primary Health Center, Dhobi Ghat and Other Buildings in Padmanabhanagara Constituency. Amount put to Tender (Including GST): ₹. 1,00,00,000/- EMD Amount: ₹. 2,00,000/-
2	Additional Development and Construction of Dog Shelter at Sy.no.179 in S.Bingipura Village (400 Dogs). Amount put to Tender (Including GST): ₹. 2,00,00,000/- EMD Amount: ₹. 3,00,000/-

Calendar of Events : (1) Pre-Bid Meeting of tender is 23-09-2026 upto 4:00 pm (2) Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tenders is 30-09-2026 upto 4:00 pm. (3) Technical Bid Opening date 01-10-2026 at 5:00 pm. (4) Financial Bid Opening date 05-10-2026 at 5:00 or Technical bid completion!
Sd/- Executive Engineer Co-ordination & Planning, BSCC



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PROFILES

Battle lines in the boardroom

Tata Sons

The group's promoter company faces questions over leadership, ownership and regulatory issues amid growing differences over who should serve as its executive chairman and whether the company should be listed

Lalatendu Mishra

Tata Sons Pvt. Ltd, the principal investment holding company and promoter of Tata group companies, was established in December 1917 as a trading firm to manage the profits of its operating businesses. Headquartered at Bombay House in South Mumbai, Tata Sons earns its income from dividends paid by its operating companies. It is governed by a board comprising executive chairman N. Chandrasekaran; Tata Trusts' nominee directors Venu Srinivasan and Noel Naval Tata; independent directors Harish Manwani and Anita M. George; and executive director and chief financial officer (CFO) Saurabh Agarwal.

Today, Tata Sons, the group's promoter company, faces questions over leadership, ownership and regularly issues amid growing differences over who should serve as its executive chairman and whether the company should be listed.

Tata Trusts, the philanthropic trusts established by contributions from members of the Tata family, own 66% of the equity capital of Tata Sons. Noel Naval Tata, as chairman, heads the Tata Trusts. Through dividend income from Tata Sons, the Tata Trusts support education, health, livelihood generation, scientific research and art and culture across the country.

Until 2017, the company was known as Tata Sons Ltd., a public company. It was made private that year and renamed Tata Sons Pvt. Ltd. Some of the large group companies in which Tata Sons has investments include Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Tata Steel, Tata Motors, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles, Tata Chemicals, Tata Elxsi, Titan, Trent, Tata Power, Tata Capital and Tata Consumer Products. It has several unlisted companies as well, including Tata Projects, Tata Advanced Systems, Tata Digital and Air India. In recent years, it has invested in new businesses such as semiconductors, electronics manufacturing, batteries, aviation, digital commerce, telecom



Opposing sides: Noel Tata and N. Chandrasekaran

equipment and defence manufacturing.

Each Tata company or enterprise operates independently under its own board of directors. An unusual business entity, Tata Sons is majority-owned by philanthropic trusts, manages independently run companies and is privately held. This distinctive structure has defined the Tata group for more than a century.

Tata Sons was established during the chairmanship of Sir Dorabji Tata, the elder son of Tata group founder Jamsetji Tata, who served as chairman from 1904 to 1932. The other chairmen of Tata Sons included Sir Nowroji Saklatvala, J.R.D. Tata, Ratan Naval Tata, Cyrus Mistry and, currently, Natarajan Chandrasekaran.

Besides Tata Trusts, the other shareholders of Tata Sons include the Shapoorji Pallonji Group (SP Group), with an 18% holding; Tata group companies, with about 13%; and individuals, mostly Tata family members, who hold about 3%. For FY2026, Tata Sons reported a standalone profit of ₹31,961 crore, up 22% from the previous year, while

revenue increased 9.1% to ₹42,367 crore. Consolidated revenue reached ₹16.24 lakh crore and profit rose 52% to ₹1.71 lakh crore.

Multiple challenges

While Tata Trusts, the majority shareholders, have opposed and disputed the September 17 re-appointment of executive chairman for a third term starting in February 2027, the company's board has ratified the decision. The move has brought the board into direct confrontation with the majority stakeholder, led by Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata, raising questions over who ultimately governs Tata Sons.

There was another development that heightened the tensions within the group. In a major regulatory development, the Reserve Bank of India, on September 11, 2026, rejected Tata Sons' application, made on March 28, 2024, for voluntary surrender of its Certificate of Registration to be classified as an unregistered Core Investment Company (CIC).

The RBI, after keeping the application under examination for

nearly two and a half years, directed Tata Sons to comply with the regulations applicable to upper-layer non-banking finance companies (NBFC), a move that has been interpreted as mandatory stock exchange listing. Under RBI rules, NBFCs in the upper layer are subject to enhanced requirements, including mandatory listing within the prescribed regulatory framework.

While the company's board, by a majority vote, has approved a resolution to comply with the RBI's directive, its majority owner, Tata Trusts, do not want the company to be listed. The Trusts argue that keeping Tata Sons privately held is integral to the ownership model through which dividends support philanthropy.

With these two major developments, the conflict between the Tata Sons board and Tata Trusts has become public. Both sides are preparing for a bitter legal battle, which could be a replay of what had happened a decade ago.

Ten years back, the Tata Trusts had to assert their authority to oust then Tata Sons executive chairman, Cyrus

Mistry, in a boardroom battle. In October 2016, Ratan Tata, who had retired as Tata Sons chairman in 2012, returned as its interim chairman, and fought a bitter battle with Cyrus Mistry and the Shapoorji Pallonji Group (SP Group).

Chandrasekaran, then TCS managing director and chief executive, was appointed executive chairman of Tata Sons in February 2017.

Until his death in October 2024, Ratan Tata retained considerable influence over the affairs of Tata Sons. Ratan Tata first became chairman of Tata Sons in 1991 and continued until 2012. He also headed Tata Trusts, leaving little scope for a conflict between the company and its shareholders.

Increasing differences

Differences have surfaced since Noel Tata, the half-brother of Ratan Tata, took over as Tata Trusts chairman in October 2024. Over the past few months, the differences have become increasingly visible. The matter has been complicated further by the SP Group's support for a listing, as it seeks to monetise its stake to meet its financial obligations.

The Tata Trusts have offered the SP Group an opportunity to dilute its stake, valued at about ₹25,000 crore, in 18 months to avoid a listing. But in a recent statement, SP Group chairman Shapoorji Pallonji Mistry, who is Noel Tata's brother-in-law, welcomed the RBI's decision and backed the listing of Tata Sons.

Tata Sons is today a combination of an investment holding company, a capital allocator, a promoter of dozens of businesses and a bridge between a large commercial conglomerate and its philanthropic owners.

As battle lines are drawn between the Tata Sons board and its majority shareholder, the coming months will determine whether the board or its majority owner prevails. More fundamentally, the tussle raises a question about the future of Tata's distinctive ownership model and whether it can survive in its present form.

THE GIST

While Tata Trusts, the majority shareholders, have opposed and disputed the September 17, 2026 re-appointment of current executive chairman for a third term starting in February 2027, the company's board has ratified the decision

The move has brought the board into direct confrontation with the majority stakeholder Tata Trusts, led by chairman Noel Naval Tata

What complicated the matter further is the position of the SP Group in favour of listing of Tata Sons as it wants to cash out to meet financial obligations

Not in a mould

Anant Nag

The versatile Kannada actor, who explored multiple genres ranging from social drama and romance to comedy and horror, has been honoured with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award

Bageshree S.

“I would call it be-having, not acting,” veteran actor Anant Nag once said, pithily summing up his approach to the craft. With his skills forged on the Mumbai stage and not in a film school, reliance on what he called “behavioural” acting has stood Nag in good stead as he has easily moved between parallel and commercial cinema, exploring multiple genres from social drama to romance to comedy to horror.

The actor will on September 22 receive the Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024, for his contribution to Indian cinema over five decades, at the 72nd National Film Awards ceremony in Gujarat. He was awarded Padma Bhushan last year. Nag is the second Kannada actor to win the Phalke after Dr. Rajkumar.

Born Anant Nagarkatte in 1948 in Uttara Kannada district in coastal Karnataka, Nag spent his childhood in a religious math and an ashram where his parents worked. Moving to Mumbai in his early teens for schooling was a culture shock, but he found his feet in Mumbai's vibrant theatre world of the 1960s and 70s, acting in Konkani, Kannada and Hindi plays.

Nag's transition to cinema came in 1973 with *San-kalpa* by P.V. Nanjaraje Urs



ILLUSTRATIONS: SREEJITH R. KUMAR

in which he played a rationalist pitted against religious faith. A year later, he was introduced to Shyam Benegal with whom he worked in six films that remain milestones of Indian new wave cinema of the 1970s and early 80s, starting with *Ankur*, where he plays a complex-ridden son of a landlord. *Nishant*, *Manthan*, *Bhumika*, *Kondura* and *Kalyug* followed, offering him a range of roles with grey shades.

Commercial stint

Nag has often said his move to commercial cinema followed a realisation that a full-time career was hard in parallel cinema. *Bayalu Daari* (1977) was his first major commercial hit as a romantic lead, and a string of others followed such as *Chandanada Gombe*, *Benkiya Bale* and *Naa Nimma Bidalare*. He played the vulnerable middle-class protagonist in many of these based on popular novels, and his on-screen pairing with Lakshmi was a particular hit. Interestingly, Nag was

popular in an era of superstars like Rajkumar, Vishnuvardhan and Ambarish, who had fan clubs that often competed with each other. Nag, despite his huge fan following, steered clear of this phenomenon, perhaps partly because he was never an “action hero”, and partly because he defied being cast in a mould.

An important phase of his acting career was his collaborations with his younger brother Shankar Nag, a maverick talent of Kannada film and theatre, who died in an accident in 1990. While films they did together such as *Accident*, *Minchina Ota* and *Nodi Swami Navirode Heege* continue to have a unique place in Kannada cinema, it was the series *Malgudi Days* based on R.K. Narayan's works that won them national recognition in the early years of television. Nag has poignantly written about this association in the memoir, *Nanna Thamma Shankara*.

After a lean period in the late 1990s, Nag conti-

nued to act in 2000s, but mostly in supporting roles, in films like *Mungaru Male*. He came back to playing key roles again in films like *Godhi Banna Sadharana Maikattu*, with stellar performance as an Alzheimer's patient, and *Kavala Daari* where he plays a retired police inspector.

Nag is also one of the few Kannada actors to have successfully dabbled in politics. He was influenced by the JP Movement of the 1970s and was persuaded by the late Chief Minister, Ramakrishna Hegde, to join mainstream politics. He was nominated to the Karnataka Legislative Council in 1988 and was later elected to the Legislative Assembly. In 1996, he became Bangalore Development Minister in the J.H. Patel government. He quit politics, by his own admission, when it began to demand his full attention, away from cinema.

But Nag has never shied away from wearing his political views on his sleeve. He has been an unabashed admirer of Prime Minister Narendra Modi over the past few years and has endorsed Hindutva politics on many occasions, drawing criticism from liberal circles in Karnataka. When asked to comment on Phalke award, Nag said the congratulatory post on X from the Prime Minister “felt as good as getting two Phalke awards”.

The digital recruiter

Shahzad Bhatti

The Pakistani social media influencer's campaign to establish fear and clout in India has spread to 14 States, leading the Home Ministry to designate his network as a terror group

Vijaita Singh

Over the past two-years, the name of a social-media influencer from Pakistan has been surfacing in several terror-related investigations in India.

What started as a bid by the individual identified as Shahzad Bhatti to establish fear and clout in the border State of Punjab, soon spread to 14 States, with several young men finding themselves behind bars under the stringent anti-terror law, the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act (UAPA), for acting on his directions. Their assigned tasks included pasting posters glorifying Bhatti and his associates, installing CCTVs near critical installations, which were being live-streamed into Pakistan, or making extortion calls.

On September 16, the Union Home Ministry designated the ‘Shahzad Bhatti Network’ (SBN) as a terrorist group under the UAPA. The Ministry said in a notification that through its terrorist activities, the outfit poses a “serious threat to the democratic system, communal harmony, and internal security of the country”. Over 200 suspects, linked to the SBN, were detained or arrested in a countrywide counter-terror operation ahead of Independence Day.

Bhatti, who speaks Pun-



jabi and regularly posts video on Instagram and Facebook with a filter to enhance his looks, currently operates from the UAE. Dressed in traditional pathani suit, his videos, mostly shot while getting off an expensive car or next to a snooker table, always have boastful background music.

Links to the ISI

Security officials said he has graduated from “organised crimes” to “terror-related activities” over the past year, and was tapped by Pakistan's Inter-Service Intelligence (ISI), considering his reach among Indians through social media. Several of his Instagram accounts, which always end in ‘333’ have been flagged by security agencies. Before the pre-Independence Day pan-India raids and arrests against the SBN, Delhi Police had blocked 125 Instagram accounts related to Bhatti. Since October 2025, the police registered 15 FIRs and arrested 69 accused, two-thirds from

Punjab and Uttar Pradesh. Those arrested were poorly educated, economically vulnerable individuals recruited via social media for money, lured with the promise to relocate to the Gulf, or for resolving personal issues.

Bhatti's earliest association with criminal activities in India started from Punjab and it soon spread to Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Delhi, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Uttarakhand, Karnataka, Gujarat, Bihar, Telangana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir and Kerala.

The SBN is the 46th outfit to be designated a “terrorist organisation” under Section 35 (I) of the UAPA, 1967, which empowers the Ministry to designate an outfit as a “terrorist organisation.”

Without mentioning the specific cases against the SBN, the Ministry notification listed nine categories of crimes registered under Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), Information Technology Act, 2000, Explosives Substances Act, UA-

PA, the Official Secrets Act, 1923 (OSA), the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 and the Delhi Prevention of Defacement of Property Act, 2007. The Ministry said the SBN is an organisation whose objective is to involve gullible youth and local criminals to smuggle arms, explosives, and narcotics from across the border.

A Uttar Pradesh police officer said Bhatti contacted young men who engaged with his social media posts and offered them ₹5,000-₹10,000 to put up posters carrying his images in public places to project him as a gangster and instil fear. He later recruited some of them to throw grenades or plant explosives near critical installations. The payments, often originating from Central Asian countries, were transferred directly to bank accounts.

After assessing a recruit's willingness to take risks, Bhatti allegedly assigned more serious tasks, including installing Chinese-made CCTV cameras near railway stations, air bases and arterial roads, with footage livestreamed to Pakistan. In one instance, he allegedly sent online manuals to men in Punjab on making petrol bombs and an IED. “In some cases, money was the motivation, while in others, religious sentiments were exploited,” the officer said.

ANOTHER SHOT

Quimcy loses in teqball semifinal, to play for bronze medal next



INSTAGRAM@QUIMCYY

India's Quimcy Dsouza could not put it past Indonesian Sumaya despite giving her all in a gruelling three-game teqball women's singles semifinal on Saturday but remained in contention for a bronze medal at the Asian Games in Nagoya. Quimcy let slip the early advantage to go down 12-7, 9-12, 7-12.

REMEMBRANCE

Missed Jaspal sir a lot: Manu after an emotional opening ceremony



IOA

Manu Bhaker said she missed her late coach Jaspal Rana during the Asian Games opening ceremony, making an already special occasion an emotional one as she carried the Indian flag. "Missed Jaspal sir a lot today; he was a flag-bearer at the Asian Games. It was indeed an emotional day without his presence by my side".

THE PRIORITY

Let's focus on giving our best instead of complaining: Manu



FILE PHOTO: R.V. MOORTHY

Manu Bhaker urged Indian athletes to not waste their energy in pointing out organisational chaos that has marred the Asiad build-up and instead focus on giving their best. "We've worked hard to be here... medal may come or not, that is another story, but we must give our best." The shooting competition begins on Sunday.

ON THE PROWL

We have to go all out and be raging tigers on the court, says Chirag



FILE PHOTO

We want to win a medal. Last time we won (the men's team) silver and were so close to winning gold. We were leading 2-0 against China. It's a new tournament. Whatever happened last time is done and dusted. We have to go all out and be raging tigers on the court — Chirag Shetty, right, India doubles badminton star.

One Asia, one heart as continental extravaganza begins

Emperor Naruhito formally declares the mega event open; host Japan's entry during the parade of nations draws the loudest cheers; Aichi-Nagoya's industrial might, too, on display in the ceremony

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Games with a Heart. The Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games opening ceremony left no one in doubt on what the city and the organisers were aiming at at the Mizuho Park Athletics Stadium here on Saturday, the heart in all its myriad symbolism pervading every aspect of the event.

Throughout the approximately 110-minute presentation, the repeated emphasis on heart, unity and oneness was unmissable, right from the heart-shaped, inclined stage in the middle of the field to the placards carrying the teams' names during the athletes parade.

Even the outfits for performers accompanying

violinist and composer Taro Hakase during his recital were heart-shaped, as were the 'angel drones' dressed up in flowing fabric, invoking the diversity and solidarity of Asian countries.

"This giant heart, being born from a fusion of diverse artists, performers, visuals, stage mechanisms, and systems, is sure to become a message originating in Aichi-Nagoya that spreads to Asia and even to the entire world. People around the globe will relate to and connect with each other through joy and friendship," chief creative director Yukihiko Tsutsumi said in a statement.

He didn't need to spell it out. Everything in front of the packed stands of the completely rebuilt, rechristened 35,000 capacity Paloma Mizuho Stadium that was formally opened only in April made it amply

clear that the city was keen on showcasing itself as a centre for hospitality, culture and performing arts, the opening ceremony's design concept itself titled 'Harmonic Heart Beat'.

Even the cauldron that was lit at the end of the ceremony was heart-shaped to depict one Asia, one heart. Hammer throw legend Shigenobu Murofushi, accompanied by his Olympic champion son Koji Murofushi, did the honours.

Host Japan's entry during the parade of nations expectedly drew the loudest cheers, matched only by the welcome for the royal family, with Emperor Naruhito formally declaring the Games open.

Earlier, the pre-show that started at 4 p.m. included performances by artists from the Shigo Bonote Preservation Society and the INI Music Group.

With the Nagoya Castle at its centre, the 'Heart Beat of Tradition' had performances by kabuki artists before the past made way to the present and future, the inevitability of Aichi-Nagoya's industrial might too big to be ignored even in the midst of all the heart on display. But even there, the display made references to the historical origins of the city's manufacturing prowess

The extent of technology integration with everyday life meant many of the songs used during the ceremony were created with AI. But the messaging was plain — beyond the heavy industry that it is known for and the mechanical excellence it prides on, Nagoya's ambitions were now bigger, embracing its historical past as well as its softer side to attract more people than just the hard-nosed businessmen.



Carrying the hopes: Kabaddi men's team captain Pawan and shooter Manu lead the Indian contingent in the march past. R.V. MOORTHY

Kit goof-up sees Pawan replacing Tajinderpal as India's flag-bearer

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Two-time Asian Games defending champion Tajinderpal Singh Toor was replaced as India's flag-bearer by kabaddi star Pawan Sehrawat since the shot putter didn't have his ceremonial kit. Manu Bhaker was the other flag-bearer.

The reasons for the mix-up, however, are not clear. Tajinderpal, who was part of the Indian contingent that left early to train and acclimatise at the Tsukuba University, had apparently forgotten to pack it in his kit before departure.

It was later known that the Athletics Federation of India had failed to pick up the ceremonial kits from the Indian Olympic Association.

Sources said the AFI was unaware of the entire goof-up until Tajinderpal decided to get his outfit ready, even though it had acknowledged and appreciated the IOA's decision to name him for the role.

Tajinderpal, too, posted



Tajinderpal... missing out. FILE PHOTO

a video thanking the IOA for the honour. In fact, the entire Indian athletics squad missed out on the opening ceremony on Saturday.

Either way, with no time for the kit to reach Tajinderpal despite the best efforts, the gentle giant was forced to pull out of what would have been the highlight of an illustrious career.

Sports Ministry wants IPL owners to invest in HIL and other leagues

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Even as rumours of a Hockey India (HI) Executive Board meeting sans president Dilip Tirkey on Friday made rounds sparking questions of legality and conspiracy theories, the Sports Ministry is known to have made it clear that it would brook no violations while ensuring that the federation and the beleaguered Hockey India League continued without a hitch. Sources in the know revealed that the ministry was looking at existing Indian Premier League



We are aware of the potential for a sport and refuse to believe anyone who says hockey is a loss-making proposition MINISTRY SOURCES

owners and franchises to get involved in the HIL as well to ensure sustainability and success. The recent good performance by the Indian women's hockey team, with a large part of the credit going to the WHIL, has also impressed the ministry enough to get

involved if necessary.

Interestingly, JSW — co-owner of IPL side Delhi Capitals — already has both men's and women's teams in the HIL, making it clear that the idea is not as far-fetched as it might seem. The ministry, in fact, is keen on the IPL owners getting involved in other leagues as well, including the Pro Kabaddi League and the Prime Volleyball League among others.

"We are also aware of the potential for a sport and refuse to believe anyone who says hockey is a loss-making proposition. It might reflect on their

shortcomings, not the sport's. The IPL owners have been positive in their responses. The HIL will happen and will continue," ministry sources declared.

Asked about the recent administrative tussles within the federation, officials simply said, "everything will be sorted (out). Neither (the) HIL nor HI is going anywhere."

The meeting on Friday, meanwhile, under the acting chairmanship of Tapan Das, announced holding the HI elections on November 7. It remains to be seen how things pan out in the coming days.

Ministry taps into diaspora to tide over issues faced by the athletes

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

The Indian government has tapped into the small but important Indian diaspora to tide over the accommodation and food issues for the country's athletes at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games.

With continued shortage of places to stay and little help from the organisers, the Indian officials have decided to make their own arrangements to ease athletes' concerns.

Coordination Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya landed in the city on Friday morning and sources said he had been coordinating with the chef de mission and other IOA members here.



Ready to help: Mandaviya reached out to the Indians in Nagoya. X@MANSUKHMANDVIYA

The Indian management has created a three-layer support system for the athletes, starting with two members at the airport to guide and help them through the formalities and transportation, followed by three more at

the Welcome Centre for smooth transition. With just 2,000 Indians in Nagoya, officials have also identified and confirmed 10-12 homes so far to accommodate athletes as a last resort.

"Given that there have

India starts favourite against Bangladesh

Press Trust of India
NISSHIN

Defending champion India will look to continue its dominant run against Bangladesh in the Asian Games women's cricket semifinal here on Sunday.

The Women in Blue hardly broke a sweat as they began their title defence with a facile eight-wicket win over host Japan, chasing down the target of 58 with 15 overs to spare on

Friday.

Bangladesh advanced to the semifinal on the basis of its higher ICC ranking after the quarterfinal against China was abandoned due to a wet outfield.

India has dominated the head-to-head record, winning the last nine meetings, including a 40-run victory over Bangladesh in the semifinal of the Asia Cup last week.

Match starts at 10.30 a.m. IST.



Spinning success: Shree Charani, centre, was the pick of the Indian bowlers in the quarterfinal against Japan. X@BCCI WOMEN

Campbell in WI ODI squad for India series

Press Trust of India
ST. JOHN'S (ANTIGUA)

West Indies has recalled John Campbell to its ODI squad for the upcoming series against India while promising opener Kamil Pooran has earned his maiden T20I call-up for the assignment against the reigning world champion.

Shimron Hetmyer has been left out of the ODI squad but will join the team for the five-match T20I series.

The West Indies will play three ODIs and five

T20Is against India from September 27 to October 17 across eight cities.

The squads:

ODIs: Shai Hope (Capt.), Jewel Andrew, John Campbell, Keacy Carty, Roston Chase, Matthew Forde, Justin Greaves, Amir Jangoo, Alzarri Joseph, Shamar Joseph, Vitel Lawes, Gudakesh Motie, Keemo Paul, Sherfane Rutherford, and Jayden Seales.

T20Is: Hope (Capt.), Andrew, Chase, Forde, Shimron Hetmyer, Akeal Hosein, Shamar Joseph, Motie, Paul, Kamil Pooran, Rovman Powell, Rutherford, Quentin Sampson, Romario Shepherd, and Shamar Springer.

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Sunday (all times IST):

Badminton: Women's team (round-of-16): vs. Kazakhstan, 11.30 a.m.

Cricket: Women (semifinal): vs. Bangladesh, 10.30 a.m.

Hockey: Women (Pool B): vs. Uzbekistan, 7.30 a.m.; Men (Pool A): vs. Indonesia, 11.30 a.m.

Shooting: Women: 10m air rifle individual qualification and team final (Sonam, Vidarsa, Elavenil), 6.15 a.m.; individual final, 11 a.m.

Swimming: Men: Heats (from 7

a.m.): 100m freestyle (Benedicton, Akash); 100m backstroke (Rishabh, Utkarsh). Finals (from 2.15 p.m.).

Table tennis: Women's team (Group F): vs. Indonesia (6.30 a.m.); vs. Singapore (12.30 p.m.). Men's team (Group F): vs. Indonesia (9 a.m.); vs. Iran (3 p.m.).

Teqball: Women's singles bronze match, Quimcy vs. Sakamoto (Jpn), 6.30 a.m.; Mixed doubles bronze match, Quimcy & Anas vs. Nguyen & Trinh (Vie), 7 a.m.

Wushu: Men's Changquan final: Suraj, 5.30 a.m.



Before sunrise: Workers begin their day at the salt pans near Beeramgunta coastal village, near Ongole, in Prakasam district.



White fields: Workers walk across the salt pans near Beeramgunta as the day's work gets under way.



Manual harvest: A worker uses a simple wooden tool to rake and pull salt crystals from the surface of a pan.



Crystal ground: A worker labours in the morning light near Kothapatnam coastal village in Andhra Pradesh; for thousands of families along the coast, salt-making is a vital source of livelihood.

In pursuit of salt and survival

Thousands of workers in Prakasam's coastal mandals depend on salt production, enduring long hours in brine and intense heat; an extended dry season has prolonged salt production this year, but overproduction has pushed down prices, leaving workers vulnerable to losses and an uncertain livelihood



Kommuri Srinivas

Before the sun rises over the Bay of Bengal, the salt pans near Ongole in Prakasam district of Andhra Pradesh are already stirring. In the dim light, workers walk toward the shimmering white fields to begin another day of labour – work that leaves an indelible mark on their bodies and lives. Behind the glittering mounds of salt lies a world shaped by sweat, uncertainty, and an unending struggle for survival.

Thousands of workers in the coastal mandals of Kothapatnam, Naguluppapadu, Chinna Ganjam, Singarayakonda and Vetapalem depend on salt production for their livelihood. The salt season begins in mid-December, coinciding with the festive period leading up to Sankranti, and continues till the rains in July. However, this year, the El Niño has extended the dry season, and salt production continues. Workers repair mud bunds, pump concentrated brine into the pans and, under the scorching sun, scrape salt crystals from the surface by hand or with simple wooden tools. In remote salt fields without proper roads, they carry the harvested salt on their heads and pile it along the bunds.

The work is gruelling. Spending long hours in brine and intense heat exposes workers to skin

ailments, eye irritation, and joint pain. Sunlight reflected off the white crystals places additional strain on their eyes.

This harsh occupation also affects family life. For some families, finding suitable marriage alliances for their sons outside villages where salt farming is the main occupation is usually very difficult.

Every season is a gamble. An unexpected spell of rain can wash away months of hard work, while falling salt prices can wipe out the meagre incomes of workers, as in this season. While the monsoon has made its presence felt in most districts of coastal Andhra, Prakasam remains dry. The salt prices have fallen because of overproduction.

In a normal year, once the monsoon arrives, a hush settles over the salt pans, and these salt workers turn to government employment schemes, fishing, and other temporary jobs to make ends meet.

Yet, with every new season, they return to the salt pans. Their footprints disappear beneath the crystals, but their struggle remains etched across the landscape – a reminder that behind every gleaming mound of salt is a life built on labour, hope and resilience.



Back-breaking labour: Workers move between the salt pans as they begin another day; the work involves long hours in intense heat and brine.

